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CM FLAGS DARK SPOTS, BROKEN PATHS AT DU NORTH CAMPUS P3



'INDIA VERY CLOSE TO ACHIEVING GOAL OF ELIMINATING TUBERCULOSIS' P6

INDIA EYE LEAD AGAINST WI P12



GST officers lose arrest powers

Council raises prosecution bar to Rs 5 crore; Most refunds in 3 days

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8



Union Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman addresses a press conference after the 57th Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council Meeting at Bharat Mandapam, in New Delhi on Thursday ANI

TAKEAWAYS

- **The council has approved an easier process for small suppliers to register on e-commerce platforms**
- **Also, the council has approved a Rs 10,000 threshold for serving GST notices**
- **Sitharaman said the process reform under GST 2.0 has been driven by the principle of trust and is part of the 'Reform Express' under Prime Minister Narendra Modi**
- **The process reforms will be implemented from April 1, 2027**

The GST Council on Thursday approved a sweeping overhaul of tax administration, removing GST officers' power to arrest taxpayers, raising the threshold for criminal prosecution to Rs 5 crore, and providing a faster 3-day refund for most claims.

The council has approved an easier process for small suppliers to register on e-commerce platforms. This includes a simplified procedure for making changes to GST registration, a reduction in penalties, and the establishment of a committee of officials to address the transition towards invoice matching for input tax credit claims.

A Committee of Officers, expected to submit its report within 3 months, will examine the issue of protecting a genuine buyer who holds a proper invoice, has received the goods and has paid his supplier in full. Also, the council has approved a Rs 10,000 threshold for serving GST notices.

Addressing reporters after the 57th GST Council meeting, Sitharaman said the process reform under GST 2.0 has been driven by the principle of trust and is part of the 'Reform Express' under Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The process reforms will be implemented from April 1, 2027.

"Business has to be trusted. Taxpayers have to be trusted. And businesses among themselves with trust if they do it, we shouldn't be too intrusive... In GST next gen reform, 99 per cent issues have been addressed, (both in) rate or process," Sitharaman said.

The Council, chaired by Sitharaman and comprising her state counterparts, met after a little over a year since the tax rate rationalisation.

GST rates have settled, and revenues are growing with stability despite the rate changes announced last year, she said.

Announcing the second set of reforms under GST policies, Sitharaman said she expects process reforms, announced on Thursday, to take one year to stabilise.

Sitharaman said the Council agreed on faster refunds, wherein the acknowledgement period will come down from 15 to 10 days. CONTINUED ON P4

US suspends IT giants from green-card prog



WASHINGTON: The US on Thursday suspended IT firms Cognizant, Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL, Capgemini, Microsoft and Adobe from the Permanent Labour Certification Programme, which allows companies to apply for green cards for H-1B visa workers. The announcement was made by US Labour Secretary Keith Sonderling, with Vice President JD Vance, the head of the US Anti-Fraud Task Force, by his side. "I am hereby suspending from the Permanent Labour Certification Programme by some of the largest IT outsourcing firms in the world, Cognizant, Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL, and Capgemini," Sonderling said. SEE P11

ASKS GOVTS, TELCOS, FINANCIAL COS TO TEAM UP

PM calls for global framework on cyber fraud and deepfakes

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8



HIGHLIGHTS

- **He said India has gained considerable experience in tackling cyber frauds and is ready to share its learnings with the world**
- **Modi warned that cyber frauds and cyber crimes do not respect borders and asserted that technology achieves scale only when it gains trust**

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday called for a global framework to tackle cross-border cyber frauds and the growing threat of deepfakes, urging governments, technology companies, telecom operators and financial institutions to come together for a mechanism to prevent such frauds before they reach the people.

He said India has gained considerable experience in tackling cyber frauds and is ready to share its learnings with the world.

Modi warned that cyber frauds and cyber crimes do not respect CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Seemapuri: Death toll rises to five

NEW DELHI: The death toll in the Seemapuri building collapse rose to five on Thursday after two more bodies were recovered from the debris at the site in east Delhi, an official said. The two deceased have been identified as Nusrat alias Guria and Hajra Bibi, he said. The victims found earlier included a 12-year-old girl, 21-year-old Gulafsa, who was around four months pregnant, and a child aged around one-and-a-half years. MPOST

SC orders more beat patrolling

NEW DELHI: Stressing the importance of crime detection and prevention, the Supreme Court has directed Delhi Police and the city government to enhance beat patrolling, particularly around educational institutions, and undertake strict verification of drivers and assistants of public transport vehicles.

Passing a slew of directions in a suo motu case titled 'In Re: Recent rape incidents in Delhi NCR', the apex court directed that unauthorised liquor shops and establishments operating without requisite permissions be identified and dealt with in accordance with law. A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran issued notice to the Union Ministry of Home Affairs and the Delhi Transport Department and posted the matter for hearing on November 16. SEE P2

RENTED FOR RS 16K A NIGHT

Teen's rented Audi hits 3 vehicles, kills pedestrian

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8

KEY POINTS

- **The pedestrian, Umashankar, a 45-year-old resident of Kishangarh, sustained serious injuries in the collision and was rushed to the JPN Apex Trauma Centre, where he was declared dead**
- **The company which leased the car to the minor is also under the police scanner**

A 17-year-old boy allegedly crashed an Audi car he rented for a friend's birthday into three vehicles in southwest Delhi's Kishangarh, killing a pedestrian, police said on Thursday.

The teenager had rented the car through an online app for Rs 16,000 for a night, the officer said.

The accident took place around 2.30 am on October 4 near a CNG pump at the Kishangarh red light, where the recklessly driving juvenile rammed his car into three vehicles, the officer said.

The pedestrian, Umashankar, a 45-year-old resident of Kishangarh, sustained serious injuries in the collision and was rushed to the JPN Apex Trauma Centre, where he was declared dead.

"During the investigation, police apprehended the juvenile driver and produced him before the Juvenile Justice Board through video conferencing," the officer added.

The police seized all vehicles, including the Audi, and filed an FIR at the Kishangarh Police Station under sections 281 (rash driving) and 106(1) (causing death by negligence) of the BNS, and Section 3/181 of the Motor Vehicles Act.

The company which leased the car to the minor is also under the police scanner. "If any lapse or violation is found, appropriate action will be taken," the source said.

The police are also examining CCTV footage from cameras CONTINUED ON P4

Rajghat sit-in, B'luru stir: Oppn targets CEC

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8



Leaders of Opposition grouping INDIA bloc on Thursday staged a peaceful sit-in at Mahatma Gandhi's memorial at Rajghat to highlight what they alleged was "hijacking" of the country by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah, and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar through a criminal conspiracy of 'vote chori'.

After two days of fierce protests during which several leaders, including Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, were detained and forcibly removed by the police, the Opposition leaders assembled at Rajghat CONTINUED ON P4

Liquor shops to remain closed on October 9, 10

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government on Thursday directed the closure of liquor stores in the city on October 9 and 10 due to the "prevailing" situation to maintain public order. SEE P2

Anne Carson wins Literature Nobel

STOCKHOLM: Canadian poet, essayist and translator Anne Carson won the Nobel Prize in literature Thursday for playful, genre-blending works that fuse the classical and the modern.

The Toronto-born Carson, 76, draws on themes and stories from ancient Greek and Roman literature for writing that often blends elements of poetry, essay and fiction. SEE P9

India rejects Elon Musk's Starlink 'blocking' claim



NEW DELHI: India on Thursday rejected Elon Musk's allegation that Starlink's satellite internet services were being blocked by domestic business interests, saying all satellite communications companies were subject to the same regulatory and security requirements. The telecom ministry said the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services was "fair and non-discriminatory" and called any suggestion that it was being applied selectively "baseless and misconceived". SEE P9

Cancer drugs set to get cheaper

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

GOVT TO CAP TRADE MARGINS AT 30% OF MRP FOR ANTI-CANCER DRUGS

The Centre has decided to cap trade margins at 30 per cent of maximum retail price for all non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs, covering branded and generic, domestic and imported, patented, and non-patented medicines, government sources said on Thursday.

The move addresses excessive trade mark-ups and aims to improve affordability while ensuring continued availability of these life-saving medicines, the sources said.

The decision, which is expected to be implemented later this month, will bring down prices of 110 anti-cancer drugs, including 35 patented medicines.

"The primary aim of the trade margin rationalisation (TMR) is to prevent misselling malpractices. There is a tendency to sell drugs having a bigger margin, and since anti-cancer drugs are more expensive than the rest, we wanted to cap the trade margins on them," the sources said.

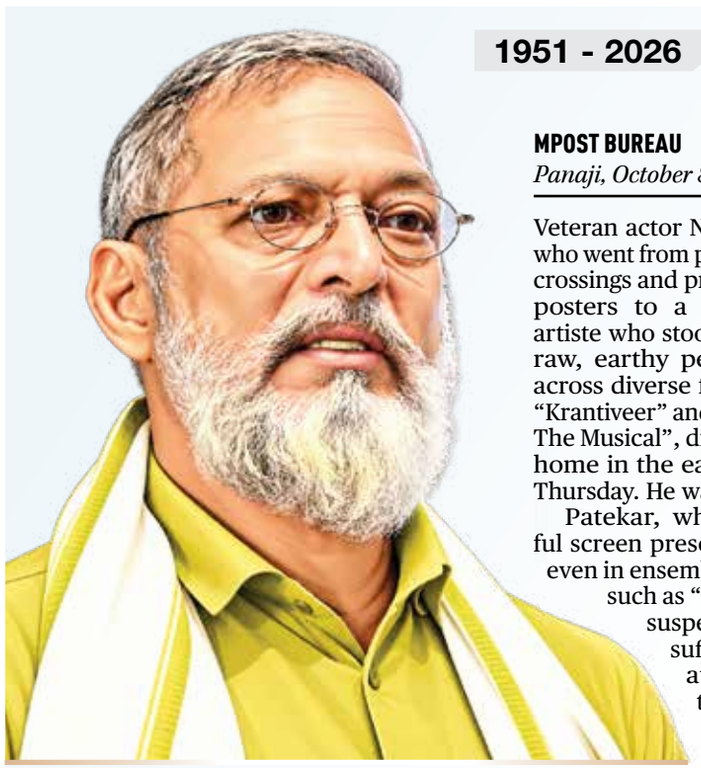
The move will lead to an estimated annual savings of Rs 2,500 crore of cancer patients, they said.

The Supreme Court had on September 29 voiced its concern on the issue of highly-inflated price of anti-cancer drugs. CONTINUED ON P4

VETERAN ACTOR, KNOWN FOR POWERFUL PERFORMANCES, DIES AT 75

Nana, take a bow

1951 - 2026



MPOST BUREAU
Panaji, October 8

ACTOR EXTRAORDINAIRE

- **Just four days ago, he said at an event in Goa, 'We all have to go someday. I don't know whether I will be here tomorrow'**
- **The actor was the recipient of three National Film Awards for his roles in 'Parinda', 'Krantiveer' and 'Agni Sakshi', several Filmfare Awards, the Maharashtra State Film Award and Filmfare Awards Marathi**
- **He also received Padma Shri, the country's fourth-highest civilian honour**

Veteran actor Nana Patekar, who went from painting zebra crossings and printing movie posters to a mainstream artiste who stood out for his raw, earthy performances across diverse films such as "Krantiveer" and "Khamoshi: The Musical", died at his Goa home in the early hours of Thursday. He was 75.

Patekar, whose powerful screen presence was felt even in ensemble comedies such as "Welcome", is suspected to have suffered a heart attack, doctors said.

The actor was taken to a private hospital after he was found unconscious at his apartment in Dona Paula, near Panaji, said Dr Shekhar Salkar, a senior doctor at the medical facility said.

Despite being administered CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation) for 45 minutes, Patekar could not be revived and was declared dead at 5.10 am, he said.

The sudden death of the actor, who effectively captured the anger, helplessness and disillusionment of the common person in his roles, came as a shock to his colleagues and friends.

Just four days ago, he said at an event in Goa, "We all have to go someday. I don't know whether I will be here tomorrow." The words underscoring the fragility of life. CONTINUED ON P4

AI, AI Express & Akasa Air hike fuel surcharges



NEW DELHI: Air India and Air India Express on Thursday announced hiking fuel surcharges for domestic and international flights, while Akasa Air raised the surcharge for overseas flights due to soaring jet fuel costs.

The hike in fuel surcharges from October 9 will push airfares higher as airlines look at ways to partially offset the rising operational costs.

Air India and Air India Express, which previously revised fuel surcharges in April, have increased them by Rs 101 to Rs 301 for domestic flights. For international services, the hike ranges from USD 5 to USD 15.

Akasa Air has re-introduced the fuel surcharge for domestic services and increased it for international flights. The airline, which introduced the surcharges in March, later withdrew them for domestic flights.

In a statement on Thursday, Air India said Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) prices have witnessed significant volatility in recent months, driven largely by geopolitical developments and sustained pressure on global energy markets.

For domestic flights, Air India and Air India Express have revised fuel surcharges ranging from Rs 400 to Rs 1,200, depending on the distance. SEE P11

Over 20,000 cops, paramilitary deployed for October 10 protest

Guidelines issued for handling women protesters; daily briefings ahead of proposed stir

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



KEY POINTS

- The officer said no permission has been granted for any protest at Jantar Mantar
- 'We are well prepared and motivated to handle the law-and-order situation in the city on Saturday. No permission has been granted so far for any protest at Jantar Mantar,' the officer said
- Deployment was made as a precautionary measure to prevent any breach of peace, ensure the smooth movement of people and traffic

More than 20,000 police and paramilitary personnel have been deployed across Delhi ahead of the Cockroach Janata Party's October 10 protest, a senior officer said on Thursday.

The officer said no permission has been granted for any protest at Jantar Mantar and appealed to people to avoid participating in any unauthorised gathering.

"We are well prepared and motivated to handle the law-and-order situation in the city on Saturday. No permission has been granted so far for any protest at Jantar Mantar," the officer said.

The deployment was made as a precautionary measure to prevent any breach of peace and ensure the smooth movement of people and traffic. The officer said prohibitory orders are already in force in the area.

"Prohibitory orders are in force, and everyone is requested to follow the law and maintain peace," the officer said.

The police have also appealed to protesters and members of the public not to indulge in any violence or attack the force members deployed for security duties.

"We appeal to everyone to maintain peace and not attack police personnel. Any such act is a crime and strict legal action will be taken against those found involved," the officer said.

The police have issued specific instructions to personnel regarding handling women protesters and have told them to avoid unnecessary confrontation.

Daily briefings are being conducted to bring all members of the force on the same page, the officer said.

The police have cautioned people against believing or circulating unverified information on social media or elsewhere.

"People should not believe or circulate fake news merely because they have seen something online. They are requested to trust only the official social media handles and verified communication channels of Delhi Police," the officer said.

The Cockroach Janata Party and several student groups have been demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over allegations against him of presiding over the deletion of lakhs of voters across the country in the name of Special Intensive Revision of Voter lists.

'Police registers FIR to identify people behind violence during Jul 20'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



The Crime Branch of the Delhi Police has registered an FIR to investigate the violence that broke out during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest in the national capital on July 20, police sources said on Thursday.

The probe will focus on identifying people allegedly responsible for the violence and examine whether it was premeditated, the sources said.

On the directions of the Supreme Court, the Delhi Police had cancelled 17 FIRs registered at multiple police stations in the New Delhi district.

The FIR comes two days ahead of another CJP protest announced to be held at Jantar Mantar, this time to press for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise. A police officer said that permission has not been granted for any protest.

Referring to the fresh FIR, the police source told PTI that teams of the Crime Branch will also look into whether criminal elements entered the protest sites after the CJP called for a march towards Parliament on July 20. The violence during the protest involved alleged assaults on police personnel, vandalism and damage to public property, including police vehicles. The protesters also had also alleged excessive force against them by police during the protest.

Crime Branch will examine 2,873 people with criminal backgrounds identified through Facial Recognition System, which police said has approximately 50 per cent accuracy overall.

Liquor shops in city to remain shut on Oct 9 and 10

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8

The Delhi government on Thursday ordered the closure of all retail liquor vends in the city on October 9 and 10 as a preventive measure to maintain public order.

An Excise Department order, issued on the basis of inputs from the Delhi Police, directed the closure of liquor outlets operating under specified licences, including L6, L6&L6FG, L8, L10 and L8&L14.

However, hotels, clubs, bars and restaurants holding valid excise licences to serve liquor will remain open.

The decision comes amid calls for a protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10 over demands for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. More than 20,000 police and paramilitary personnel have been deployed across Delhi, with no permission granted for the proposed gathering.

Forged PwD cert racket busted; 9 held, 27 certificates recovered

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



POLICE RECOVERED 16 PWD CERTIFICATES ISSUED BY GOVT HOSPS IN UP, ALONG WITH THREE MOBILE PHONES

The Delhi Police has busted an alleged interstate racket involving forged disability certificates used to facilitate admissions under the Persons with Disabilities (PwD) category, apprehending nine people and recovering 27 certificates, an officer said on Thursday.

The investigation began with the arrest of Lalit Kumar alias Aditya, 36, from Faridabad on August 31. Police recovered 16 PwD certificates issued by government hospitals in Uttar Pradesh, along with three mobile phones and a laptop.

According to police, Lalit worked with education consultants, including Roshan Kumar of Noida, to collect students' details and arrange forged certificates for Rs 20,000-30,000 each. Aadhaar addresses were allegedly altered using AI tools before applications were submitted on the Unique Disability ID (UDID) portal.

Roshan was apprehended on September 1, while Kuldeep, a contractual computer operator at the Bareilly Divyang office, was arrested on September 3. Police alleged Kuldeep helped prepare forged medical reports.

Others arrested include Sher Singh Solanki, Bareilly disability board member Dr Laxmi Kant Saxena, Siddharth Nagar senior malaria inspector Jai Prakash Shukla, his acquaintance Surendra Rastogi, Adesh Singh and Deoria CMO office junior assistant Dhirender Kumar Pandey.

Police alleged Shukla misused his position to facilitate certificates, while Pandey prepared forged documents for Rs 5,000 each.

The force recovered a laptop, MacBook, desktop, 11 mobile phones, Rs 75,000 cash and a Mercedes car. Police are searching for Chandan Singh Yadav of Gorakhpur and examining the role of doctors and students linked to the certificates.

SC directs enhanced beat patrolling, verification of public transport staff

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



THE COURT DIRECTED ENHANCED PATROLLING AND EFFECTIVE REAL-TIME MONITORING OF POLICE, CCTV INFRASTRUCTURE...

The Supreme Court has directed Delhi Police and the city government to strengthen beat patrolling, particularly around educational institutions, and ensure strict verification of drivers and assistants of public transport vehicles.

A bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran, hearing a suo motu case on recent rape incidents in Delhi-NCR, also directed authorities to identify unauthorised liquor shops and establishments operating without requisite permissions and take action against them.

The court directed enhanced patrolling and effective real-time monitoring of police and CCTV infrastructure through dedicated control rooms or "war rooms". It asked the Delhi Police Commissioner and Delhi Chief Secretary to submit a joint report on existing command centres, their coverage and emergency response protocols.

The court also directed strict verification of drivers of buses, cabs, taxis and autorickshaws, including those linked to app-based aggregators. Only registered and verified persons should operate such vehicles, while their names and photographs should be displayed prominently for passenger identification.

Authorities were asked to provide dedicated channels for complaints and take prompt regulatory action against violations.

The bench further directed beat officers to monitor eateries and establishments serving liquor unlawfully, disperse loitering or crowds around liquor shops and ensure safe movement of pedestrians.

It called for regular citizen-engagement meetings to address grievances and stressed preventive-policing training for personnel. While emphasising crime prevention, the court cautioned that policing must remain lawful, proportionate and accountable. It issued notice to the Union Home Ministry and Delhi Transport Department and listed the matter for November 16.

29-yr-old dies after jumping into drain following argument

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Noida, October 8



A 29-year-old man allegedly died by suicide after jumping into a drain near the Sector 81 metro station here following an argument with his wife over his alcohol consumption, police said on Thursday.

Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police, Noida, Abhay Kumar Mishra said the local Sector 39 police station received information through Dial-112 on Wednesday that a man had jumped into a drain near the metro station with the intention of taking his own life.

"Police identified the man as Ravi, a native of Etah who was currently residing in Harola under the jurisdiction of Phase-1 police station," Mishra said.

A search operation was subsequently launched by the local police, fire service and National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), following which the man's body was recovered, the ADCP said.

"According to the man's wife, she had an argument with Ravi over his alcohol consumption, following which he allegedly jumped into the drain in a fit of anger," Mishra said.

Police completed the inquest proceedings and sent the body for post-mortem examination.

DUSU launches 26 cells to widen student participation

New Delhi, October 8

The ABVP-led Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) has launched 26 student cells aimed at providing students with platforms to pursue their interests, develop skills and participate in campus activities.

The initiative follows the ABVP's victory in the DUSU elections and covers areas ranging from culture, sports and fine arts to technology, research, entrepreneurship and community outreach. Other cells include those for alumni relations, diversity and inclusion, students with disabilities, legal aid, international students, mental health and wellness, media and publications, women empowerment and the North-East.

DUSU said the cells would broaden student participation, encourage leadership and help students develop their talents through new ideas and greater involvement. MPOST

NDMC hands over 1,000 kg of organic compost to Lok Niwas

Initiative is part of NDMC's 'Swachhata Hi Seva 2026' campaign

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 8



THE DETAILS

- According to the civic body, the composting process takes around two to three months to produce mature organic compost. Wet and horticulture waste is processed in wire-mesh rounders at the facility
- NDMC officials said the initiative aims to promote a waste-to-resource approach...

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Thursday handed over 1,000 kg of organic compost to Lok Niwas, the Office of the Lieutenant Governor of Delhi, as part of its efforts to promote decentralised and sustainable waste management.

The compost was produced from locally processed wet and horticulture waste at NDMC's decentralised composting facility at its Hi-Tech Nursery on Madhu Limaye Marg in Chanakyapuri. The facility processes waste close to its source, reducing the amount of waste requiring transportation and final disposal.

According to the civic body, the composting process takes around two to three months to produce mature organic compost. Wet and horticulture waste is processed in wire-mesh rounders at the facility.

The initiative is part of NDMC's Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 campaign, under which the council has distributed 1,250 kg of organic compost among 11 schools.

It plans to distribute another 3,000 kg among 30 schools to promote source segregation, decentralised composting and responsible waste management among students and school communities.

The composting facility was also visited by Lieutenant Governor of Delhi on September 25 during a review of NDMC's cleanliness and sustainable waste-management initiatives.

NDMC officials said the initiative aims to promote a waste-to-resource approach by converting organic waste into a useful product, while reducing the volume of waste sent for disposal. The council said such decentralised practices would contribute towards a cleaner and greener New Delhi.

L-G TS Sandhu kicks off DDA Hockey Cup

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 8



THE EVENT WAS ATTENDED BY VISHWAS NAGAR MLA OM PRAKASH SHARMA, DDA VICE CHAIRMAN N SARAVANA KUMAR...

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday inaugurated the DDA Sports Cup (Hockey) at the Hockey AstroTurf of Yamuna Sports Complex, with 11 teams from Delhi-NCR and around 220 players, coaches and support staff participating.

The tournament, being held from October 8 to 18, will have nine playing days, with October 11 and 12 designated as rest days. It will follow a league-cum-knockout format, featuring 20 matches, including 12 league games, four quarter-finals, two semi-finals, a third-place match and the final on October 18.

The event was attended by Vishwas Nagar MLA Om Prakash Sharma, DDA Vice Chairman N Saravana Kumar, senior DDA officials, coaches and participating teams.

The tournament aims to provide young players with competitive exposure and match experience while promoting discipline, teamwork and sportsmanship. It is being organised in line with the Fit India Movement.

The DDA currently manages 19 Sports Complexes, four Mini Sports Complexes and three Golf Courses across Delhi. It said it remains committed to strengthening sports infrastructure and creating opportunities for budding sporting talent.

MCD steps up action against illegal construction

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Thursday carried out 21 demolition actions across all 12 zones as part of its ongoing drive against unauthorised constructions, dangerous buildings and building norm violations.

The civic body also sealed four properties and issued four demolition orders during the exercise. Major actions were reported at Raghubir Nagar, Sant Nagar, Gurmandi Rajpura and Kalyan Vihar.

The action followed 27 demolition drives and three property sealings on Wednesday.

The MCD said field officials had been directed to maintain strict vigilance and take action against violations of the Master Plan, Building Bye-Laws and other regulations. Enforcement will continue across Delhi.

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CM flags dark spots, broken paths at DU North Campus

Gupta inspects campus, reviews women's safety measures

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 8



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday evening conducted a surprise inspection of Delhi University's North Campus and directed officials to address dark spots, broken footpaths, inadequate lighting and gaps in CCTV coverage, with a focus on the safety of women students.

During her visit outside the Arts Faculty, Gupta interacted with women students and asked about their concerns related to safety, transportation, colleges, hostels and PG accommodation. She asked students to inform her about any difficulties they faced while travelling at night and assured them that genuine concerns would be addressed.

"If you face any problem, tell me," Gupta told the students during the interaction.

While walking through the campus, the chief minister identified several poorly lit stretches and sought details from officials. She directed authorities to identify all dark spots, install additional lights where required and prune tree branches obstructing illumination.

Gupta also expressed displeasure over broken and uneven footpaths and ordered officials to inspect the entire stretch and repair damaged portions. She stressed that pathways should also be accessible for students with disabilities.

The chief minister reviewed CCTV arrangements and sought details on the number of cameras installed and functional, besides areas requiring additional surveillance. She directed officials to install cameras wherever necessary and ensure existing systems remain functional.

She also enquired about PCR vehicle availability and the deployment of women police personnel at night. Students said women police personnel were present and PCR vehicles reached the spot when required. Gupta directed the police and university administration to strengthen coordination.

During the inspection, she also took note of garbage and poorly maintained green areas and ordered immediate cleaning.

Students also raised concerns regarding PG facilities. Gupta said the Delhi Government was preparing a PG policy that would prescribe necessary rules and standards. She also said work was underway to improve hostel facilities and construct new hostels.

PARVESH VERMA SLAP ROW

High Court seeks response from police, minister

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



The Delhi High Court on Thursday sought the response of the city police and PWD Minister Parvesh Verma on a plea seeking an independent probe into the incident where the leader allegedly slapped an AAP worker.

Justice Sachin Datta issued a notice on the petition and asked the police to file a status report.

The court also asked Verma to file his reply to the plea.

During the brief hearing, the counsel for the police raised objection to the maintainability of the petition, which also sought police protection for petitioner Sahib Singh and his family members.

The court listed the matter for further hearing on November 17.

Verma, who is the Public Works Department (PWD) minister of Delhi, had allegedly slapped a man during a road inspection in Tilak Nagar on September 27.

Sahib Singh, the person whom the minister allegedly slapped, claims to be an associate of Tilak Nagar AAP MLA Jarnail Singh. He claimed that he handles the AAP MLA's social media accounts.

The petitioner sought protection of his life and liberty, preservation of CCTV and electronic evidence and an independent investigation into his allegations of assault, threats and police inaction.

He claimed that he submitted a detailed complaint to the police commissioner on September 29, setting out the details and seeking fair and impartial investigation, legal action and protection for himself and his family.

> **THE PETITIONER SOUGHT PROTECTION OF HIS LIFE AND LIBERTY, PRESERVATION OF CCTV AND ELECTRONIC EVIDENCE AND AN INDEPENDENT INVESTIGATION INTO HIS ALLEGATIONS OF ASSAULT**

"In view of the continued threats to the petitioner and his family, the acts concerning the conduct of police personnel and the apprehension regarding independence of investigation by the local police, the petitioner has been constrained to approach this court seeking protection of his life and liberty....," the plea said.

The plea submitted that on the day of incident, the petitioner was recording the proceedings on his mobile phone when Verma allegedly became agitated over questions concerning the quality of road construction and allegations of corruption.



The petitioner alleged that he was slapped, abused and threatened, after which his mobile phone containing the video recordings was forcibly snatched and damaged.

He said the incident was recorded and streamed on social-media platforms and that he approached the SHO of Vikas Puri police station with his complaint the same day.

Making allegations over the conduct of police personnel, the petitioner claimed that while a member of Verma's security team pushed him and assisted the minister in leaving the spot, the police officials present there did not intervene.

The petitioner alleged that he has been continuously receiving threats and abusive messages and calls from various numbers and accounts on his mobile and social media.

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Thursday welcomed the Delhi High Court's notice to PWD Minister Parvesh Verma and demanded an independent inquiry.

AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj alleged that the Delhi Police had not registered an FIR against Verma. The court sought responses from the police and Verma on a plea seeking an independent probe.

The incident took place last month during Verma's inspection of a newly laid road in West Delhi's Tilak Nagar. Videos showed Verma slapping a man recording the exchange after AAP MLA Jarnail Singh questioned the roadwork. Verma alleged the man abused his family.

Govt asks top officers to inform CM, ministers before proceeding on any leave

New Delhi, October 8

The Delhi government has warned senior officers against taking leave without prior permission, directing them to seek approval from the Chief Minister and ministers concerned before proceeding on any kind of leave.

An order issued on Wednesday by Services Secretary Nandini Paliwal said instructions on leave were not being followed and the matter had been viewed seriously by the Chief Minister. Earlier directions had required additional chief secretaries, principal secretaries and heads of departments to inform the Chief Minister and ministers concerned before proceeding on leave, including casual leave.

The Services Department has now reiterated the directions and ordered that copies of leave applications from officers of the rank of head of department and above be sent to the Secretary to the Chief Minister. It warned that non-compliance would be viewed adversely and could invite action.

Officials said unauthorised leave by senior officers was a "chronic" issue despite repeated directions. Last year, some departments were also instructed to seek leave through WhatsApp. MPOST

L-G Sandhu orders crackdown on illegal parking

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 8

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has directed civic and transport agencies to intensify action against illegal parking and improve utilisation of existing facilities amid persistent parking problems and mobility bottlenecks in the Capital.

At a high-level meeting on Thursday, Sandhu asked the MCD, NDMC and Delhi Traffic Police to conduct joint enforcement drives at parking sites and prevent unauthorised parking. RWAs and market associations will also be involved in enforcement around multi-level



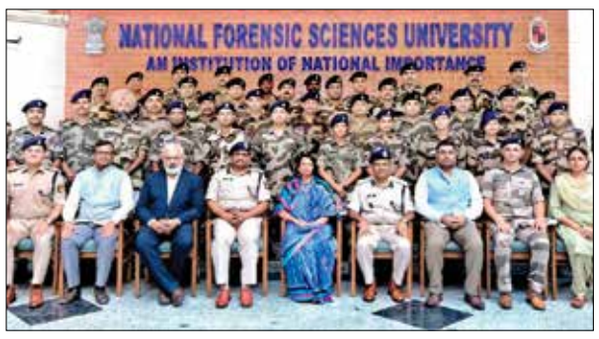
parking facilities.

The Traffic Police informed the meeting that 13,34,700 challans and 5,54,073 notices had been issued for unauthorised parking till October 5 this year, while 1,24,906 vehicles had been towed using 76 cranes.

The MCD has planned an enforcement drive from October 15 to December 15 covering identified parking hotspots and market corridors.

It currently operates 463 parking sites – 433 surface and 30 multi-level or stack facilities – with a capacity of 94,831 equivalent car spaces.

L-G Sandhu seeks uniform parking charges, expanded Park and Ride facilities, slot tracking and a unified parking authority.



40 CISF personnel complete specialised cybersecurity training at NFSU Delhi campus MPOST

MCD: Khirwar reviews Molarband civic issues

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 8

> **DIRECTED OFFICIALS TO CLEAR WASTE DUMPED ALONG ROADS IN TAJPUR PAHADI...**

The MCD Commissioner, Sanjeev Khirwar, during an inspection of Molarband on Wednesday, directed officials to complete repairs at damaged rooms of the MCD Primary School in Molarband village by Monday and temporarily shift students to a safe alternative location.

Khirwar said the safety of students should remain the priority while repair work is underway. He also directed officials to explore developing a park within the school premises to improve the learning environment.

The Commissioner also reviewed civic issues including sanitation, waste management, encroachments, healthcare facilities and waterlogging. He directed officials to examine the feasibility of starting an MCD dispensary at the POTA cabin near the Molarband Extension school.

Inspecting waterlogging on Main Jaitpur Road, Khirwar asked officials to identify the underlying cause and undertake technical measures for a permanent solution instead of relying solely on repeated pumping.

He also directed officials to clear waste dumped along roads in Tajpur Pahadi Mines and Molarband and address the issue of stray animals. At Shaheed Bijender Singh Chowk, he ordered priority action on beautification, removal of encroachments and illegal rehri vendors, cleanliness and proper maintenance of the martyr's statue.

Officials were instructed to coordinate across departments and ensure time-bound monitoring of the measures.

Mozambique team tours Delhi Metro

New Delhi, October 8

A delegation from Mozambique, led by Transport and Logistics Minister João Jorge Matlombe, visited the Delhi Metro on Thursday to learn about its training, capacity-building and operational systems.

It was received at the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) Academy by Managing Director Vikas Kumar and DMIL CEO Sanjay Jamuar, who briefed the visitors on training.

The delegation toured the Academy's facilities, including the Extended Reality (XR) Lab, Metro Signalling Model Room, Bogie Brakes Pneumatic Simulator and RS-2 Driving Simulator. It viewed documentaries on the DMRC and DMIL.

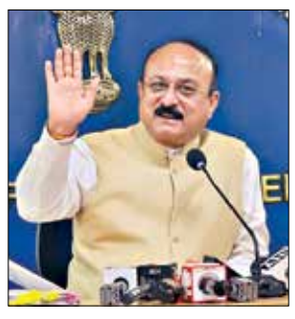
The delegation later visited the Delhi Metro Museum at Supreme Court Metro Station, where it was briefed on the network's evolution. The visit provided insights into Delhi Metro's training and simulation systems. MPOST



MCD, DDA TO INSPECT 100 PGs IN 3 DAYS

Sood moves to map Delhi's student PGs

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 8



The Delhi government is set to launch an online portal to map student paying guest (PG) accommodations across the city as part of efforts to bring the largely fragmented student housing sector under a formal regulatory framework.

The decision was taken at the second meeting of the High-Powered Committee (HPC) on Student Accommodation and Safety, chaired by Education Minister Ashish Sood on Thursday. The committee was constituted following the Satya Niketan incident to formulate regulations for PG accommodations and hostels in Delhi.

The portal will initially collect basic information, including the location of student accommodation, number of rooms and available amenities. DU and MCD will conduct a dry run of the portal within two to four days, following which the government plans to launch a campaign encouraging student registration.

"Progress was made on creating a portal to capture data on students and paying guest accommodations. We will be launching the portal very soon so that it is known where children are living in Delhi and in what kind of accommodation, enabling us to regulate them," Sood said.

The committee also decided to constitute a sub-committee comprising representatives of the DDA, Delhi government, MCD and Delhi University Vice-Chancellor to examine whether existing provisions under the Master Plan and DMC Act can be relaxed to facilitate legal PG operations.

The panel will examine the possibility of allowing regulated PG housing in areas within a 5-6 km radius of major educational hubs, as well as in group housing societies and RWA areas.

"Where issues are arising in legal operations due to restrictions in the Master Plan and DMC Act, a sub-committee will sit to study that," Sood said.

MCD and DDA will inspect 100 PGs in three days. Proposed norms include CCTV at common areas and entrances, while comprehensive regulations for student housing are being drafted in Delhi.

'WORLD HAS NOT FORGOTTEN 9/11, 26/11 & PAHALGAM ATTACKS'

India exposes Pak's duplicity at UN

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
United Nations, October 8

Exposing Pakistan's doublespeak on terrorism at the UN, India has called out Islamabad's efforts to gloss over its state support for terror by announcing rewards for JeM chief Masood Azahar, underlining that the world has not forgotten 9/11, 26/11 and Pahalgam attacks.

India on Wednesday exercised its Right of Reply in response to the Pakistan representative's statement in the Sixth Committee of the UN General Assembly on the Agenda Item: Measures to Eliminate International Terrorism.

"Pakistan speaks of combating terrorism while seeking to obscure the very question that this committee must confront: What happens when terrorists are financed, facilitated, trained, sheltered, or supported from the territory of a state?" First Secretary in the Permanent Mission of India to the UN Raghoo Puri said.

He said India has been consistent on this question, underscoring that terrorism cannot be defeated by declarations and instead requires action against its perpetrators, organisers, financiers, and sponsors.

"For years, Pakistan has presented itself as a frontline state in combating terrorism and as a victim while masking the fact that the Frankensteins the Pakistani state has created and lost control over have moved from wreaking havoc in neighbouring countries to doing the same in Pakistan," Puri said.

Calling out Pakistan's doublespeak on terrorism, Puri said the country "glosses over its state support for terrorism by announcing enhanced rewards for apprehending UN-listed head of Jaish-e-Mohammed terrorist and mastermind of several attacks against my country, Masood Azhar."

He said the world is aware of Pakistan's financial support to terrorism.

From page 1

GST officers

If neither an acknowledgement nor a deficiency memo is issued in 10 days, the claim is treated as acknowledged.

"Based on risk assessment, it is expected that the system will sanction 90 per cent of all the claims within 3 working days of acknowledgement," Sitharaman added.

So, refunds will become automatic and enhance working capital for businesses, she added.

The minister said the Council approved a concept note on an optional scheme for businesses with a turnover of up to Rs 5 crore, supplying only to consumers. This will entail filing only one annual return with quarterly tax payments.

The detailed framework will come for a decision before the next Council meeting.

The package marks a significant shift in approach to indirect-tax enforcement, nearly a decade after the goods and services tax was introduced.

The removal of arrest powers is particularly significant. Under the existing Central GST Act, Section 69 allows the Commissioner, subject to specified conditions, to authorise a central tax officer to arrest a person suspected of certain offences.

The change effectively separates tax recovery from personal liberty. Tax authorities will continue to assess and recover tax, interest and applicable penalties, but an ordinary tax dispute will no longer expose a taxpayer to arrest at the investigation stage.

The enforcement overhaul is also part of a wider push to make GST administration increasingly faceless and technology-driven, reducing direct interaction between taxpayers and individual tax officers.

The shift is intended to reduce discretion, improve consistency across jurisdictions and limit the scope for unnecessary interaction between taxpayers and officials.

For businesses, the move could mean that GST compliance becomes less dependent on the approach of individual officers and more closely tied to data generated through returns, invoices, e-way bills, input-tax-credit claims and other digital records. The decisions represent a significant change from the enforcement architecture created when GST was launched in July 2017.

Another key recommendation of the Council was that input tax credit will now be available on health and life insurance taken for employees.

On goods in transit, the Council recommended that a vehicle should be stopped only on specific intelligence, and the decision to stop must be authorised in advance by an officer not below the rank of Joint Commissioner.

The Finance Minister further said that the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) is working to implement a centralised assessment system for about 2 lakh taxpayers registered under central GST jurisdiction but having businesses in multiple states by April 1.

Currently, there are about 69.5 lakh taxpayers exclusively in CGST jurisdiction. Amongst those, about 2 lakh are under multiple CGST jurisdictions either within one state or across different states. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

PM calls

borders and asserted that technology achieves scale only when it gains trust.

"Technology achieves scale only when it gains trust. And you all know that cyber fraud and cyber crimes do not respect borders. They have already crossed boundaries," he said while addressing the India Mobile Congress 2026 here.

Highlighting the cross-border nature of cyber crimes, he said a person sitting in one country, with the help of another country, can commit a crime in a third country.

"We are also seeing what a big challenge deepfakes have become," Modi said, adding that countries need to work together on a global framework to address such emerging threats.

"Therefore, it is necessary that we work on a global framework for this. Governments, technology companies, telecom operators, and financial institutions - all will need to connect with this framework. I urge the GSMA and telecom operators across the world: come, let us create a global mechanism that can stop such fraud before it reaches the people," Modi said.

Industry body GSMA represents mobile network operators and companies across the global ecosystem.

Modi said strengthening the security framework around telecom and digital technologies was equally crucial for their rapid expansion, with phone and network security becoming priorities.

India has learnt a lot from its experiences in this direction and is always ready to share its experiences with the world, he said.

"An ordinary citizen does not think in the language of protocols or architecture; for them, trust is paramount," he said.

For an ordinary citizen, trust means knowing who is calling, whether a message is genuine or fake, whether a payment is safe and whether personal data is secure, Modi added.

Mobile phones have evolved beyond being a means of communication and have become an important tool for governance and delivery of public services, the PM noted, and emphasised the need to strengthen safeguards against cyber threats in a growing digital ecosystem.

Recalling that 5G was launched in the country from the IMC platform in 2022, Modi said 5G connectivity has now reached every district. More than 5.5 lakh base stations are operating the 5G network, and mobile internet speed has increased 10 times compared with 2022, he said.

The prime minister also highlighted India's experience with digital governance and said Direct Benefit Transfer had enabled nearly Rs 50 lakh crore to be sent directly to beneficiaries' mobile-linked bank accounts. He said nearly Rs 5 lakh crore has been saved from going into the "wrong hands".

Modi asserted that he was determined to stop "wrong practices".

"Now tell me, those whose ill-gotten income has stopped, will they love Modi? Did I do the right thing or not? Should it be done or not? Should all these wrong practices be stopped or not? No matter how much they shout or scream, I have made up my mind, and I will get it done," he vowed.

He observed that had the old system prevailed, Rs 5 lakh crore of the government would have gone into leakages, filling the pockets of such people.

"Modi has stopped this," he said, adding that the money is now reaching rightful beneficiaries and being used for the right causes.

Under the PM-KISAN Samman Nidhi, more than Rs 4 lakh crore has been deposited into farmers' bank accounts, the prime minister said. The amount is disbursed every four months, and farmers receive the message on their mobile phones, he said.

The prime minister also said that India had moved from being a consumer to a creator in the telecom sector and was advancing towards designing products and owning technology and intellectual property in the country.

He said the 'Reform Express' was moving rapidly in the telecom sector, with decades-old laws being modernised and a modern regulatory framework created through the Telecommunications Act.

"Work is also being done from our side to rationalise structural burdens such as AGR and bank guarantees, to turn burdens into wonders," Modi said, adding that the Gati Shakti Sanchar Portal has made right-of-way approvals faster through digital means.

He said the India Mobile Congress had an important role to play in shaping the roadmap for the next decade of the mobile market, not just in India but globally.

"IMC should be remembered for the partnerships that were forged here, for the research projects that commenced here, for the products that reached the world from here, and for the innovations that emerged from India to serve humanity," he said.

Audi hits 3

installed around the accident spot and adjoining roads to reconstruct the sequence of events leading to the crash, the source said. Whether there were more people in the Audi is also part of the probe.

The police have written to the app-based rental firm seeking details of the booking and the documents submitted while taking the vehicle on rent, as well as the details of the person who did the booking and who took the delivery, the source said.

Location and movement of the vehicle during the rental period are being ascertained, the source said.

The finding will reveal whether the juvenile was driving the vehicle throughout the period or whether it was driven by another person at any point.

The police are also trying to ascertain the identities and ages of all the occupants who were allegedly travelling in the Audi when the accident occurred.

A search for eyewitnesses who may have seen the Audi being driven before the collision or witnessed the crash is on, the source said.

Oppn targets CEC

to offer floral tributes and pray for "wisdom to the BJP government and the chief election commissioner".

INDIA bloc constituents Shiv Sena (UBT) and NCP (SCP) have not taken part in the protests till now. The opposition leaders are now seeking time to meet President Droupadi Murmu to present their case and demand the CEC's dismissal.

"The truth is that Narendra Modi, Amit Shah, Mohan Bhagwat, and Gyanesh Kumar have hijacked the country through a criminal conspiracy. They have destroyed the Constitution and stolen votes. They will be brought to justice. This is our guarantee, and you will see it happen," he asserted.

Gandhi spoke after Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge hosted a lunch for opposition MPs and leaders in a restaurant in Connaught Place. After the lunch, the leaders moved to Rajghat in three buses accompanied by hundreds of supporters raising slogans and waving flags.

Amid drum beats, the bus procession moved slowly via Minto Road and Asaf Ali Road, crossing Delhi Gate and Delite cinema with members of Youth Congress, NSUI, and Left organisations raising slogans against Modi, Shah and Kumar.

The workers waved the tricolour, and also flags of their parties and organisations.

The nearly five-km distance was covered in about two hours. Upon reaching Rajghat, the leaders went to the memorial and sat there in silence while paying floral tributes to Mahatma Gandhi.

Kharge said, "We have peacefully protested and raised the issues of the public. We came here to Gandhi ji's memorial to pray for wisdom for this government. Vote 'chori' must be stopped, those who have committed mistakes should resign, and the voting rights of citizens must remain protected."

On the sit-in at Rajghat, he said the opposition highlighted before the country that the BJP government is "snatching away our right to vote. Modi and Shah are snatching away that freedom which great leaders like Gandhiji, Nehru ji, and Sardar Patel ji had won for us."

Party leader K C Venugopal said the greatest message that the opposition is giving at the memorial of Mahatma Gandhi, who helped the country gain freedom, is to keep the freedom of India intact.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh, Venugopal, and Congress' head of media and publicity department Pawan Khera, along with leaders from CPI-M, CPI, TMC, RJD, and SP, asserted that the agitation will continue on Friday.

TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee and SP leader Ram Gopal Yadav are expected to join Friday's proceedings. Banerjee would have joined the protest Thursday but her flight was delayed for almost two hours due to a bomb scare that turned out to be a false alert, the sources said.

CPI-M leader John Brittas said if CEC Kumar's masters - Modi and Shah - are bent on protecting him, they will also sink with him.

Besides Congress leaders, TMC's Abhishek Banerjee, Menaka Guruswamy, Saket Gokhale, Samirul Islam and SP's Rajeev Rai and Mohibullah, CPI-M's Brittas, CPI's Sandosh, RJD's Manoj Kumar Jha and Sudhakar Singh were also present at Thursday's lunch.

Meanwhile, the opposition against the SIR intensified in Benguluru with CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, YouTuber Dhruv Rathee, and actor-activist Prakash Raj joining a protest, demanding the scrapping of the electoral roll revision exercise and the resignation of CEC Kumar.

Addressing the protest described as 'People's Tribunal' and organised by civil society groups and the CJP at the historic Freedom Park, Dipke alleged that voter name deletions under the SIR aimed to disenfranchise those opposed to the BJP. He also accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the EC of "undermining" democracy.

Claiming that people whose names had been deleted from the electoral rolls were present at the agitation, Dipke said their presence demonstrated they were alive despite being listed as deceased. "Narendra Modi became Prime Minister by deleting and stealing votes," he alleged.

Dipke said, "People who were declared dead are standing here alive. So the death that has taken place is not the death of these people. It is the death of the democracy of this country."

He claimed that 13 crore votes had been deleted across India and around one crore in Karnataka, stating this figure represented 13 to 14 per cent of the registered vote share. Such deletions had helped the BJP win states it could not have won even during the peak of the Modi wave.

The RSS ideology did not believe in an inclusive India or the philosophies of Dr B R Ambedkar and 'Periyar' EV Ramasamy, and instead it invoked Nathuram Godse, the CJP founder claimed. "We have to fight against that ideology to save our democracy and to save our country," Dipke said.

Describing Mahatma Gandhi as the soul of India, Ambedkar as its backbone and Jawaharlal Nehru as its mind, Dipke said the country's foundation was laid by the three leaders.

Demanding the CEC's resignation, YouTuber Dhruv Rathee alleged that there was "zero transparency and zero accountability from the Election Commission" regarding the SIR exercise.

He alleged that 'Vote Chori' (vote theft) concerned every citizen irrespective of their political affiliation. "Whether you vote for the BJP, whether you vote for the Congress, or whether you support any other party, this is an issue that concerns every citizen of the country," he said.

Rathee stressed that his participation was not on behalf of any political party and said the issue should concern BJP supporters as well.

In another related development, the Delhi High Court agreed to hear on Friday a plea by the Indian Youth Congress seeking permission to hold protest against CEC Kumar at Jantar Mantar over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise.

The plea was mentioned for urgent listing before a bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma on Thursday.

The Indian Youth Congress (IYC), through its national president Uday Bhanu Chib, approached the court challenging Delhi Police's October 1 communication denying them permission to organise a peaceful demonstration at Jantar Mantar.

Defending Election Commission, a group of 42 retired judges backed the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, describing it as a lawful exercise.

In an open letter to the "people of India", the former judges of the Supreme Court and former chief justices and judges of various high courts said they hold no brief for any political party but felt compelled to speak as "silence is no longer a neutral choice".

The former judges claimed that India's constitutional bodies are under "sustained attack", with the Election Commission of India at the centre of the assault.

"Even the higher judiciary, which we hold in high esteem, and statutory agencies have not been spared," the letter pointed out.

They said the attacks were not reasoned criticism but appeared to be a "calculated campaign" driven by vested political interests, with little regard for the potentially devastating consequences of "destabilising the world's largest democracy". The former judges described the attacks on the poll panel and other institutions as a "campaign without evidence".

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Cancer drugs

Batting for a uniform 16 per cent margin on all medicines, a bench of Justice Vikram Nath and Justice Sandeep Mehta told Solicitor General Tushar Mehta appearing for the Centre, "This is carnage. Plain and simple. The cancer drug is priced at an MRP of Rs 27,000 despite being supplied to retailers for Rs 2,700."

The government sources, however, said the decision to cap the margins on the drugs was not related to the ongoing case but has been in the works since 2019. The health department has constituted a committee to finalise the list of drugs, the sources said, adding that the issue of pricing of other medicines needs a calibrated approach.

Once finalised, these medicines with the new rates will also be available at hospitals, they added. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Nana

Patekar is survived by his wife Neelkanti and son Malhar.

According to information provided by a friend of Patekar to the hospital doctors, the actor had messaged him around 3.30 am that he was not feeling well.

"The friend saw the message around 4 am and rushed to the apartment of Patekar, who was living with a caretaker," Salkar said, adding that an ambulance was sent to the actor's house, which is about five minutes away from the hospital.

"The treatment started in the ambulance itself," Salkar said. The doctors tried to revive him after being brought to the hospital but he was declared dead at 5.10 am.

After the postmortem, the actor's body was taken to his Pune farmhouse for the last rites, where he will be accorded state funeral.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi condoled Patekar's death in a post on X, saying the actor's death leaves a deep void.

"Few actors possessed the intensity, individuality and unmistakable presence that Shri Nana Patekar Ji had. He brought remarkable versatility and creativity to every role and gave us characters that will be remembered for generations. He was also admired for his frank and forthright views, never hesitating to express what he believed in," the PM said in a post on X.

"Shri Nana Patekar's contribution to Hindi and Marathi cinema was immense. His passing leaves a deep void. My condolences to his family, friends and countless admirers. Om Shanti," he added. Shah Rukh Khan, his co-star in "Raju Ban Gaya Gentleman", said Patekar was a masterful actor and an unbeatable carrom champion.

"When I first met him, out of awe and awkwardness I fiddled with my hair. He slapped my hand away and said 'hero ki tarah Baal mat bana...tu actor hai'! He didn't flatter you. He didn't tell you what you wanted to hear. He told you what you needed to hear. That was Nana. Straightforward. Rough, honest and had the most beautiful smile," Shah Rukh said in a post on X.

He was born Vishwanath Patekar into a Marathi family in Murud-Janjira in Raigad district as the youngest of three brothers on January 1, 1951. His father had a small business but that failed when he was still in school, forcing the actor to earn money by printing movie posters and doing other odd jobs.

"When I was in the ninth grade, someone made my father sign something bad and he lost everything and I started earning. I would come from school in the afternoon, eat something, walk for sixteen kilometres everyday to print movie posters. I would get Rs 35 a month and one meal a day," he told Amitabh Bachchan during an appearance on KBC in 2024.

Patekar, who studied at Sir J J School of Art, never forgot his humble origins or the humiliation and invisibility he suffered because of poverty, often recalling his early struggle in interviews later.

"I studied commercial art there (at JJ School of Art). After that, I worked as a visualiser in an advertising agency. Then you had to choose between theatre and the job. So, I left the job and continued with theatre. In those days, we were poor.

"Our dean, he used to assign us government work... That would help me earn some money. Sometimes there would be the job to paint the zebra crossing. We would get Rs 15 for that but then you did not have to beg anyone for money," Patekar said on KBC.

He came to acting through Marathi theatre where Patekar stood out as a talented artist to look out for through Vijaya Mehta-directed plays "Hamida Bai Chi Kothi", "Mahasagar" and the long-running "Purush", which he first did at the age of 16. It was Smita Patil who encouraged Patekar to join films, but he was hesitant, fearing his unconventional looks would lead to rejection.

Patil and Farookh Sheikh's 1978 film "Gaman", directed by Muzaffar Ali, marked his Hindi cinema debut, but it would take him a decade to finally move to the big leagues with Mira Nair's "Salaam Bombay!" in 1988.

Then came Vidhu Vinod Chopra's "Parinda", his own directorial "Prahaar: The Final Act", patriotic drama "Tirangaa", commercial hit "Krantiveer" and Sanjay Leela Bhansali's "Khamoshi: The Musical", each performance earning him acclaim, awards and wider popularity.

For "Prahaar", the actor trained in the Maratha Light Infantry regiment. Former Army chief and union minister VK Singh helped him in his training and also had a cameo in the movie.

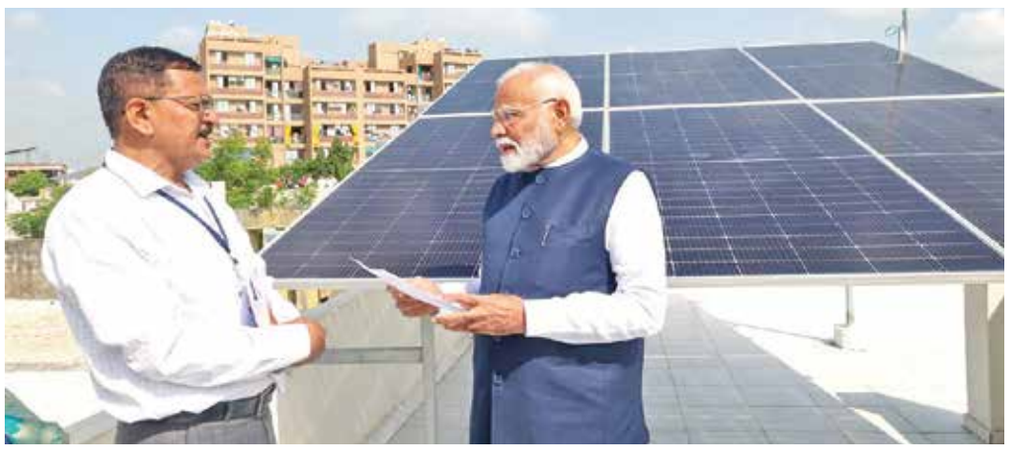
Patekar convinced Defence Minister George Fernandes during the Kargil War in 1999 to work with the soldiers on the frontline. He spent about 60 days, during which he was posted at different locations, including Drass, Mughal Pora and Baramulla. Patekar was also a member of the Quick Reaction Team (QRT).

The actor was the recipient of three National Film Awards for his roles in "Parinda", "Krantiveer" and "Agni Sakshi", several Filmfare Awards, the Maharashtra State Film Award and Filmfare Awards Marathi.

He also received Padma Shri, the country's fourth-highest civilian honour.

READER ENGAGEMENT INITIATIVE

POWERING DELHI'S FUTURE: TRANSFORMING ROOFTOPS INTO CLEAN ENERGY HUBS



How the Delhi Government and Central Initiative are Making Solar Adoption Seamless and Accessible for Every Household

Self-reliance in the energy sector, the promotion of clean energy, and environmental protection are vital for India's contemporary development. In alignment with this comprehensive vision, the 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana', launched under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, is encouraging crores of families across the nation to adopt rooftop solar.

Launched in February 2024, this central scheme aims to install rooftop solar systems on the homes of one crore families nationwide. Under this scheme, assistance is being provided to eligible families to make up to 300 units of electricity free every month. The broader vision behind this initiative by PM Modi is not merely to reduce electricity bills, but to transform households into active participants in energy production and strengthen India in the renewable energy sector.

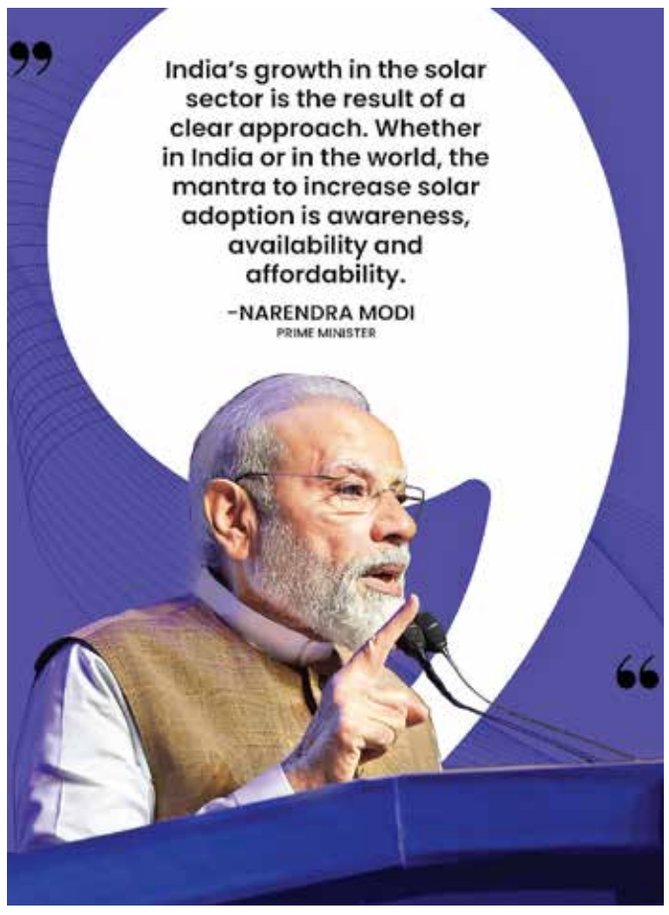
YOUR ROOFTOP, YOUR ELECTRICITY

In a metropolis such as Delhi, where a large number of families live in independent houses, flats, and residential complexes, rooftop solar is emerging as a vital alternative. Electricity can be generated directly on the home rooftop through solar panels. This helps reduce dependence on traditional electricity sources and allows families to increase the share of clean energy in their energy consumption.

Carrying forward the visionary outlook of PM Modi, the Delhi Government under the able leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has taken significant steps to implement the 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana'. The resolve expressed by the PM to make the common family of the country not just an electricity consumer, but a partner in energy production, is being taken to every household in the capital.

KEY FEATURES & FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE STRUCTURE OF THE SCHEME

FACILITY / SUBJECT	Details and Provisions
CENTRAL FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE	Up to Rs 78,000 assistance provided by the Central Govt for systems up to 3 kW (Up to 2 kW @ Rs 30,000/kW, and an addl Rs 18,000 for the 3rd kW). (Note: Includes provisions up to Rs 18,000/kW for Group Housing Societies up to 3 kW per house and area load including EV connections up to a max limit of 500 kW, as specified in variant documents).
DELHI GOVERNMENT'S ADDITIONAL SUPPORT	**The Delhi Government is providing additional capital subsidy of up to Rs 78,000 along with a top-up for tender price gaps for eligible consumers consuming an average of up to 400 units monthly in FY 2025–26. (Note: Includes up to Rs 11,000/ kW for GHS and EV loads up to 500 kW in specific versions).**
ZERO UPFRONT COST SOLAR	Rooftop solar systems up to 3 kW are available with zero upfront cost for families with an average monthly consumption of up to 400 units in the financial year 2025–26.
FREE MAINTENANCE	**Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of the solar system will be handled free of cost by the concerned vendor for the first 5 years.**
FASTER NET METERING	The net metering process has been reduced from 75 days to just 25 days.
ABOLITION OF REGISTRATION FEES	**Application and registration fees for residential solar systems up to 10 kW have been completely waived.**



Maximising Benefits: Delhi's Unique Add-On Support

The Delhi Government has supplemented central assistance with its own capital subsidy framework to make rooftop solar adoption even simpler and more attractive for Delhi residents. Under the new policy, eligible domestic consumers with an average monthly electricity consumption of up to 400 units in FY 2025–26 will be provided with a rooftop solar system of up to 3 kilowatts with zero upfront cost, subject to technical feasibility. For this:

- Central Assistance: Under the 'PM Surya Ghar Yojana', financial assistance of up to Rs 78,000 is available from the Central Government for rooftop solar systems up to 3 kW.
- State Subsidy: The Delhi Government is also providing a capital subsidy of up to Rs 78,000.
- Additional Top-Up: Furthermore, if there is a gap between the tender-determined cost of the solar plant and the available subsidies, the Delhi Govt will bridge that gap via a top-up for consumers consuming an average of up to 400 units per month.



From Power Consumers to Power Producers

Delhi's consumers will no longer just consume electricity; with Central Assistance and Delhi's additional support, they can also become solar power producers

A 3kW solar system can generate approximately 300 units of electricity. Consequently, if a family's monthly consumption is 200 units, the surplus electricity generated from the system can be fed back into the grid for benefits. According to scheme provisions, payment for the electricity fed into the grid will be made in accordance with the Discom's Average Power Purchase Cost (APVC). Thus, rooftop solar becomes a medium not just for saving on bills, but for active household participation in energy production.

Subsidies Continued, Savings Amplified Through Solar

Delhi's existing electricity subsidy scheme will continue for eligible consumers. This means eligible families receive:

- The benefit of regular electricity subsidies
- Power generation from rooftop solar
- The benefits of net metering

Specifically, for consumers consuming up to 200 units of electricity, an Energy Saving Incentive (e.g., Rs 3 per unit saved) is also provided based on the electricity saved following solar system installation. This paves the way for simultaneously enjoying free/subsidized electricity and clean energy production.



Delhi is Becoming 'Solar-Ready'

The Government of Delhi has made all information, applications, subsidies, and related facilities for rooftop solar accessible on a single digital platform via the Delhi Solar Portal.

Currently, the first phase of the Delhi Solar Scheme targets benefiting 2.20 lakh eligible consumers. So far, more than 50,000 applications have already been registered on the portal.

Citizens can apply via the national portal for the 'PM Surya Ghar Yojana'.

In the national capital, eligible consumers must select an empanelled vendor listed on the PM Surya Ghar portal to claim central subsidies.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi presented the vision of engaging common families in the energy transition through PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana.

Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government is advancing this vision in alignment with the capital's unique requirements. Combined with central financial assistance, the Delhi Government's additional capital subsidy, zero-upfront-cost options, fast-tracked net metering, and maintenance support share a unified goal: making solar energy accessible to every eligible family in Delhi.

The Delhi Government expresses its deep gratitude for this comprehensive vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and resolves to continuously push forward in transforming Delhi into a greener, energy-efficient capital through clean energy, public participation, and modern technology.



Zero Maintenance Worries with Guaranteed Support for Five Years

To ensure families have no anxiety regarding the maintenance of their solar systems post-installation, provisions have been made in the new framework. The vendor associated with the installation will operate and maintain the system free of cost for the first five years. Afterward, consumers can choose to continue maintenance and insurance coverage for up to 25 years through the DISCOMs. Thus, alongside installation, long-term smooth operation has been fully accounted for.

NET METERING NOW FASTER THAN EVER

Another critical change has been introduced for those adopting rooftop solar:

- The net metering process, which previously took approximately 75 days, has been slashed to just **25 days**.
- Additionally, application and registration fees for residential solar systems up to **10 kW** have been waived.

The government's objective is clear:

- Minimised paperwork
- Shorter waiting times
- Seamless applications
- Rapid solar connections

NEW PATHWAYS TO SOLAR ADOPTION

The Delhi Government has emphasized promoting solar energy not merely as a subsidy scheme, but as a comprehensive energy transition. Through the Delhi Solar Portal, citizens are offered diverse models tailored to their needs and economic capacity, including CAPEX, RESCO, Hybrid RESCO, Community Solar, and Group Net Metering.

- Have a roof? Install solar.
- Living in an RWA? Adopt solar for common facilities and EV charging.

The objective is not just placing panels, but making solar adoption accessible to every stratum of society.

PIONEERING TOTAL ENERGY SELF-RELIANCE

In a city where electricity demand is continuously rising, converting home rooftops into electricity generation sources is a step that seamlessly merges energy security, clean energy, and environmental sustainability.

The vision of the Delhi Solar Policy is to make solar energy accessible and affordable for all consumers in Delhi while promoting green jobs. Key objectives include reducing reliance on traditional fossil fuels, fight against air pollution and climate change, and positioning Delhi as a leader in solar adoption.

BUILDING A SOLAR CAPITAL

Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government's objective is to expand solar energy beyond government buildings to homes, Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs), Group Housing Societies, and other suitable premises.

Every suitable rooftop in Delhi is a prospective energy source. This vision can lead Delhi toward a capital where:

- Rooftops do not just offer shade; they generate energy.
- Homes do not just consume electricity; they produce it.
- Delhi is not merely an energy-consuming capital, but plays a leading role in clean energy production.

TARGETING 2.30 LAKH ROOFTOPS BY MARCH 2027

The Government of Delhi has set a clear goal for this campaign:

- **To install rooftop solar systems on 2.30 lakh homes by March 2027.**
- **To add more than 500 MW of additional rooftop solar capacity across Delhi.**

The goal is not simply to reach a few thousand homes, but to transform Delhi's rooftops into a vast network of solar energy producers, driving clean power generation at scale across the city.

DIP/SHABDARTH/ADVERTORIAL/104/26-27

OPEN LETTER TO THE 'PEOPLE OF INDIA'

Group of ex-judges defend SIR, dub Oppn attack on ECI 'campaign without evidence'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

A group of 42 retired judges have defended the Election Commission of India against the Opposition onslaught and backed the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, describing it as a lawful exercise.

In an open letter to the "people of India", the former judges of the Supreme Court and former chief justices and judges of various high courts said they hold no brief for any political party but felt compelled to speak as "silence is no longer a neutral choice".

The signatories include former Chief Justice of Jammu and Kashmir and Delhi High Court B C Patel, Former Chief Justice of Karnataka High Court Subhro Kamal Mukherjee, former Supreme Court judges Hemant Gupta and Pankaj Mittal.

The Opposition INDIA bloc leaders have accused Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar of revising electoral rolls to benefit the BJP and have sought his resignation. Both the BJP and the commission have rejected the allegation.

The former judges claimed that India's constitutional bodies are under "sustained attack", with the Election Commission of India at the centre of the assault.



FILE PIC

"Even the higher judiciary, which we hold in high esteem, and statutory agencies have not been spared," the letter pointed out.

They said the attacks were not reasoned criticism but appeared to be a "calculated campaign" driven by vested political interests, with little regard for the potentially devastating consequences of "destabilising the world's largest democracy".

The former judges described the attacks on the poll panel and other institutions as a "campaign without evidence".

"Criticism of institutions is a democratic right. Denigration is not. Constitutional authorities are now branded 'thieves', 'puppets' and 'compromised' from public platforms," they lamented.

On the SIR, the former judges noted that the electoral law empowers the EC to carry out revision of electoral rolls at any time.

They said SIRs had been carried out repeatedly since the first general elections, with the last such exercise completed about two decades ago. "No one called those revisions a conspiracy," they said.

The former judges said the allegations of "vote theft" are made at press conferences, "not before courts".

"When the commission seeks a sworn declaration, none is filed. Electronic Voting Machines are blamed only after defeat. Victories won on the same machines go unquestioned," the letter said.

In an apparent reference to the Congress, they said a party that governed the nation for over five decades now claims that the very system which elected it is rigged.

"It does not act alone. Activist outfits with a long record of selective litigation lend these claims a veneer of legality," it said.

They file petition, "one after the other" but seldom give proof. The courtroom becomes a stage, and when the judgment is delivered, it is criticised whenever it does not serve their interests, the letter said.

"Vitriol is then amplified and disseminated on an industrial scale, with the deliberate aim of eroding public confidence in a well-established and widely trusted judicial system," they said.

Security tightened at CEC Gyanesh Kumar's residence

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

Delhi Police have tightened security in and around the official residence of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the Election Commission office amid protests by Opposition parties and the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), officials said on Thursday.

Kumar is having a Z-Plus category protection which entails a minimum of 32 personnel, mainly drawn from Delhi Police. The security cover for the CEC's post was enhanced to the top category during the tenure of former CEC Rajiv Kumar by the Central government.

The development comes as INDIA bloc leaders stepped up their protests against the Election Commission, with opposition parties demanding Kumar's resignation over allegations of "vote chori" under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The CJP has also demanded the resignation of Kumar and the initiation of criminal proceedings against him. The CJP, after holding demonstrations in Mumbai and Bengaluru, have announced a march in the national capital on October 10.

On Tuesday, the INDIA bloc MPs marched from Parliament, and Rahul Gandhi observed an eight-hour sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan. On Wednesday, the scene shifted to nearby Jantar Mantar as Gandhi and other INDIA bloc leaders held a street protest against Kumar before being detained by the police later in the evening.

Thursday marked the third day of continuous protests in the national capital by top opposition leaders.

Cong trying to create 'anarchy' in India like Nepal, B'desh: BJP

Ruling party slams Rahul for pushing policeman

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

The BJP on Thursday alleged that the Congress is trying to create "Nepal- and Bangladesh-like anarchy" in the country through its street protests, as Rahul Gandhi is "desperate" to come to power.

Showing some video footage of INDIA bloc' Wednesday protest, BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari said the way Rahul, his sister Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and Congress workers manhandled the police personnel in Delhi makes the party's intention clear.

"The Congress party's strategy is to spread anarchy in India, like Nepal and Bangladesh," he said in a video message. Overlaying a purported video of the Congress protest, Bhandari said, "Congress party workers are seen trying to assault police personnel with kicks and punches. The policeman is performing his duty there, but a Congress worker pushes him and then kicks him." Showing another such video, he claimed police personnel were requesting Rahul Gandhi to hold a peaceful protest as "there is a crowd of thousands" accompanying him.

BHANDARI ALLEGED THAT 'INTERNATIONAL FORCES' WERE WORKING ALONG WITH RAHUL GANDHI TO CREATE UNREST IN INDIA

He also alleged that Rahul pushed a policeman hoping to create "resistance reels".

"In the third clip, Priyanka Vadra herself is seen attempting to push police personnel," Bhandari said.

On the Election Commission issue, Bhandari said the matter was already before the Supreme Court and claimed that the protests would have no bearing on the judicial proceedings.

"When the matter is before the Supreme Court, whether I protest on the streets, someone else does, or Rahul Gandhi does, it will not make any difference to the court," he said.

"Rahul Gandhi thinks that through such visuals, he can put pressure on the Supreme Court's decision and interfere in the judicial process," he said. He also alleged that "global international forces" were working along with Rahul Gandhi to create unrest in India.

"India's democracy is alive, strong and secure, and there is peace in the country. Are some global international forces, along with Rahul Gandhi, who is desperate to come to power, trying to bring the family back to power by burning the country and creating anarchy in it?" he said.

Joshi says elected govt should not perish 'if elections are fair'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

BJP veteran Murli Manohar Joshi on Thursday said a government elected by the people should not perish if elections are fair, governments are accountable and the bureaucracy remains transparent.

The former Union minister also said the Supreme Court should intervene if the Constitution is violated.

Joshi made the remarks while speaking to reporters on the sidelines of the 21st FICCI Higher Education Summit here.

Asked about the opposition's demand for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, Joshi said the "government of the people, for the people and by the people" would not perish provided elections were fair and the government accountable.

He said the opposition was "responsive and responsible" and had a clear alternative programme, stressing that democratic processes must operate within the Constitution.

"If the Constitution is violated, then the Supreme Court should look into it," he said.

Briefs

CBI busts exam fraud racket

NEW DELHI: The CBI has busted a multi-state impersonation racket targeting banking recruitment exams, arresting four people, including a CGST inspector. The agency said the racket spanned Delhi, Bihar, Haryana and West Bengal, with accused allegedly impersonating candidates during examinations and interviews to help unfit candidates secure banking jobs.

Pb: Pastor stabbed to death

CHANDIGARH: A 45-year-old pastor was stabbed to death with a sharp-edged weapon at his residence in Batala, Gurdaspur, police said. Pastor Balwinder Pal was attacked at Gandhi Camp and later died at Civil Hospital. A case has been registered against Naresh Kumar on his brother's complaint.

Hry: Rs 1.5 cr seized from car

HISAR: Police recovered over Rs 1.5 crore in cash from a car during checking in Hansi district, officials said. The cash was found in two bags inside the vehicle. Three occupants from Sirsa and Fatehabad could not provide documents explaining its source. The cash and car were seized, while Income Tax officials were asked to investigate.

AYODHYA VISIT

SP chief Akhilesh stays away from Ram Mandir

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Ayodhya, October 8

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav visited Ayodhya on Thursday to attend a Shrimad Bhagwat Katha at the residence of former minister Tej Narayan Pandey alias Pawan Pandey, but stayed away from the Ram Mandir.

During his visit, Akhilesh stressed the need for equality and social justice, saying there should be no place for discrimination in society.

"The feeling of belonging should be paramount and compassion should be the first condition of governance," Akhilesh said.

Referring to the PDA, or Pichhda, Dalit and Alpsankhyak social coalition, he said these sections of society had remained victims of neglect and oppression.

Akhilesh said the Bhagwat Katha conveys the message of equality and that society should foster a sense of belonging towards everyone.

His visit to Ayodhya comes months after he was at the forefront of raising questions over the alleged theft and misappropriation of devotees' donations at the Ram Mandir. In June, Akhilesh demanded judicial intervention into the allegations and questioned the handling of donations at the temple. The temple trust had rejected the allegations, saying its internal audits had not found any significant irregularities.

The issue later led to a police case and an investigation by a Special Investigation Team. Eight people were arrested in the case, and the SIT subsequently filed a chargesheet alleging pilferage of donations during the counting process.

Akhilesh's decision to not visit the Ram Mandir comes amid the SP's renewed focus on its PDA politics.

Bihar: Special enrolment drive for left-out, new voters launched

MPOST BUREAU
Patna, October 8

The Chief Electoral Office of Bihar has launched a special drive to enrol voters "left out" of the electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) last year, and the new electors, officials said on Thursday.

"Under the drive, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will conduct house-to-house verification of such voters and facilitate their enrolment through Form 6 if found eligible. The process has to be completed within a month," said the statement.

The BLOs will also share details of identified eligible voters with representatives of recognised political parties, while Electoral Registration Officers will provide booth-wise lists after completion of the drive.

INDIA bloc protest to continue until CEC Kumar resigns: Hooda

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 8



Congress leader Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Thursday said the party and the INDIA bloc would continue their agitation until Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar resigns, alleging irregularities in the electoral process.

The former Haryana chief minister and Leader of Opposition, made the remarks at a "Save Democracy, Save Votes, Save the Country" march in Ambala organised by Congress MLA Nirmal Singh and INDIA bloc parties.

Haryana Congress incharge Sanjay Dutt and state president Rao Narendra Singh were also present.

Thousands of protesters participated in the march, raising slogans over alleged "vote theft". They burned an effigy of Kumar outside the Deputy Commissioner's office and submitted a memorandum addressed to the President. The protesters demanded Kumar's resignation and called for elections to be conducted using ballot papers.

Hooda alleged that the Congress' campaign against what it describes as vote theft and irregularities by the Election Commission would intensify. He also criticised the BJP over police action against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi during opposition protests in Delhi.

Hooda claimed that Congress had received broad public support across communities in the 2024 Haryana elections but alleged that the results did not reflect the sentiment on the ground. He said he had questioned the results from the outset and that a subsequent Congress investigation had raised concerns over alleged vote manipulation.

Dutt alleged that questions raised by the Congress over the Haryana election results had not been answered. He questioned changes in the reported voter turnout, saying it rose from 61.19 per cent on the night of polling to 65.65 per cent the next day and 67.9 per cent before counting.

Civil society groups, farmer bodies back Oct 10 protest

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

Civil society groups, academics and farmer organisations on Thursday extended support to a nationwide protest planned for October 10, seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, withdrawal of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and repeal of the law governing the appointment of election commissioners.

Addressing a press conference here, senior lawyer Prashant Bhushan, Bharat Jodo Abhiyan national convenor Yogendra Yadav and other speakers alleged that large-scale deletion of names from electoral rolls was undermining democratic and constitutional rights.

They appealed to students, youth, farmers and civil society members to participate in the October 10 mobilisation in the national capital.

Bhushan alleged that more than 13 crore names had been removed from voter lists and claimed the exercise disproportionately affected poor and marginalised sections. He also alleged that permission was being denied for peaceful protests, saying the right to assemble and protest was protected under Article 19 of the Constitution.

Yadav said the issue went beyond the Election Commission or the incumbent CEC and involved the wider electoral system. He alleged that the SIR exercise had resulted in the deletion of several crore names and questioned the process through which decisions were taken.

'India very close to achieving goal of eliminating tuberculosis'

Nadda launches JOSH teams to strengthen grassroots mobilisation in fight against TB

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8



Union Ministers JP Nadda, Mansukh Mandaviya, and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta during the launch of JOSH (Joint Squad for Health) teams, in New Delhi PTI

KEY POINTS

- India's TB incidence has declined by 21 per cent compared with a 12 per cent global decline
- The country's treatment coverage has reached 92 per cent against 78 per cent globally
- Nadda called for a 'last push' to achieve the TB-free India goal

Union Health Minister J P Nadda on Thursday asserted that India is "very close" to achieving the goal of eliminating tuberculosis as he launched the Joint Squad for Health (JOSH) teams that will bring together more than 58,000 youth volunteers to strengthen grassroots mobilisation in the fight against the disease.

India's TB incidence, he noted, has declined by 21 per cent compared with a 12 per cent global decline, while the country's treatment coverage has reached 92 per cent against 78 per cent globally, and called for a "last push" to achieve the TB-free India goal.

"Today is a very historic day on which we are launching the JOSH team," Nadda said at the national launch of the initiative at Bharat Mandapam here.

"We have reached very close to the target. We need to give the last push," he said. The minister said the government has involved MPs, MLAs, mayors and councillors in the TB elimination campaign through workshops and other programmes, but the effort cannot succeed without the participation of volunteers and grassroots workers.

Nadda said the JOSH initiative was developed in discussions with Youth Affairs and Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya and Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth, with the participation of the Sports and Defence ministries.

The JOSH teams will bring together My Bharat volunteers and NCC cadets to work at the grassroots level and strengthen community participation in the TB elimination campaign.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who attended the launch, called for greater youth participation in the national TB elimination campaign. "The combined strength of health, youth and defence is giving this national mission a broad public participation-driven character," she said.

Gupta said JOSH teams would take awareness about prevention, early detection and treatment to communities. "JOSH teams will work across the country with the resolve that 'TB will lose, India will win'," she said.

EDITORIAL

The Right to Dissent

The freedom to protest peacefully is not a concession granted by the State but a constitutional entitlement flowing from the democratic character of the Republic. Articles 19(1)(a) and 19(1)(b) guarantee freedom of expression and peaceful assembly, subject to reasonable restrictions prescribed by law. Yet the growing tendency to treat public demonstrations primarily as law-and-order challenges raises troubling questions about the space available for democratic disagreement. Restrictions on protest venues, preventive detentions, prohibitory orders and extensive police deployment may sometimes be justified by genuine security concerns. However, when such measures become routine rather than exceptional, the distinction between maintaining public order and discouraging dissent begins to disappear. A democracy cannot measure its commitment to liberty merely by protecting opinions that enjoy official approval. Its constitutional strength is most seriously tested when citizens question those who exercise power.

Public order is unquestionably a legitimate responsibility of government. Authorities must protect commuters, prevent violence, safeguard public property and ensure that demonstrations do not indefinitely obstruct essential services. The Constitution itself recognises that freedoms are not absolute. Nevertheless, restrictions must satisfy the requirements of legality, necessity and proportionality. The mere possibility of inconvenience cannot justify denying citizens meaningful opportunities to assemble. Nor should speculative apprehensions about disorder substitute for credible assessments of actual threats. Police authorities must distinguish between peaceful participants and individuals engaging in unlawful conduct. Blanket restrictions frequently punish the former for risks attributed to the latter. Democratic administration requires careful regulation of protests, not their automatic displacement from public view.

The deeper concern is the gradual normalisation of administrative discretion as the determining factor in exercising fundamental freedoms. When permissions become unpredictable, designated protest spaces increasingly inaccessible and preventive measures disproportionate, citizens may find their constitutional rights intact in theory but diminished in practice. Judicial intervention remains an important safeguard, but ordinary citizens should not have to approach constitutional courts repeatedly to exercise basic liberties. Transparent permission procedures, written reasons for restrictions, accessible appeal mechanisms and accountability for excessive police action would strengthen public confidence. Equally important is the responsibility of protesters to remain peaceful, respect competing rights and avoid coercion. These obligations are complementary rather than contradictory. A credible framework must protect both the right to demonstrate and the rights of those who choose not to participate.

India's democratic history demonstrates that peaceful public mobilisation has frequently contributed to social reform, political accountability and legislative change. From struggles against colonial rule to contemporary movements demanding institutional reform, collective expression has remained integral to public life. Reducing dissent to a security problem risks weakening the relationship between citizens and the institutions meant to serve them. Governments should recognise that disagreement does not necessarily signify hostility towards the nation, just as criticism of public policy does not constitute a threat to constitutional order. The appropriate response to peaceful protest is engagement, proportionate regulation and institutional openness. Security and liberty need not exist in permanent conflict; responsible governance must accommodate both.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Green Card Uncertainty

The US decision to suspend major IT companies from green card sponsorship raises serious concerns for Indian professionals. While preventing immigration fraud is necessary, genuine skilled workers should not suffer because of corporate practices. Transparent investigations, clear timelines and safeguards for existing applicants are essential to prevent unnecessary uncertainty.

SAMEER AHMED,
BENGALURU

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Delhi at the Crossroads

Delhi's worsening civic problems have exposed deep governance failures and underscored the need for coordinated enforcement and accountability

URBAN DISORDER



RANJAN MUKHERJEE

THE WRITER IS A SENIOR IAF OFFICER

Delhi is not merely another city. As India's national capital, it houses Parliament, the Supreme Court, the Union Government and diplomatic missions. Its condition reflects the country's standards of urban governance. Yet unauthorised construction, encroachments, traffic congestion, pollution, unsafe buildings and shrinking public spaces continue to undermine liveability. The problem is compounded by fragmented governance involving multiple agencies with overlapping responsibilities. Delhi needs stronger inter-agency coordination, consistent enforcement and clearly defined accountability.

Stop unauthorised construction

Unauthorised construction should not become a demolition problem. Geo-tagged inspections, satellite monitoring, digital building approvals and comparisons with sanctioned plans can help detect violations early. Delhi's geospatial mapping infrastructure, developed in 2009, remains largely underutilised. It should be revived for continuous monitoring. Officials who knowingly permit violations must face accountability. Unregulated redevelopment and commercial activities in residential neighbourhoods also require stricter scrutiny, particularly where they obstruct natural light, increase congestion and undermine residents' quality of life.

Return public spaces to the public

Footpaths, parks and roadsides cannot become private extensions of shops, houses, commercial establishments or parking areas. Pedestrians, particularly children and elderly citizens, are frequently forced onto carriageways because of encroachments. Every major road should have clearly designated pedestrian, parking, vending, loading and emergency access zones. Enforcement must be continuous rather than dependent on occasional municipal drives.

Parking must become a managed civic service

Illegal parking remains a major contributor to congestion. Parking operators frequently accommodate more vehicles than permitted, turning public space into an uncontrolled commercial opportunity. Delhi needs scientifically managed parking facilities with fixed vehicle capacities, digital permits, camera-based enforcement, residential parking regulations and strict no-parking zones. Abandoned vehicles must be removed, while commercial areas should have designated loading hours. Civic authorities must prevent illegal operators from exploiting public roads.

Traffic management must focus on people

Challan collection cannot be the sole measure of traffic enforcement. Building additional flyovers will not resolve congestion without an integrated mobility strategy. Delhi must combine Metro services, buses, walking, cycling, last-mile connectivity and scientific parking management. Schools and markets require specialised traffic arrangements. Despite improvements in public transport, dependence on private vehicles remains excessive. Awareness campaigns, incentives and regular public transport use by political leaders and senior officials could encourage behavioural change.



Delhi already has laws. What it lacks is consistent enforcement

DELHI'S CIVIC CRISIS DEMANDS MORE THAN TEMPORARY DRIVES AND PROMISES OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORM

Pollution requires year-round management

Delhi's air pollution cannot remain an annual winter emergency. Road dust, construction emissions, vehicle pollution, waste burning and poorly managed demolition debris require continuous monitoring. Construction sites must comply with enforceable dust-control measures, while redevelopment permissions need closer scrutiny. A publicly accessible dashboard should identify pollution hotspots, violations, enforcement action and the agencies responsible. Pollution management must become a permanent municipal responsibility.

Fire and structural safety must become non-negotiable

Delhi continues to witness preventable fatalities arising from fires, waterlogging and structural deficiencies. Fire safety cannot be reduced to obtaining certificates. Schools, hospitals, hotels, markets, coaching centres, commercial buildings and high-rise residential structures require periodic inspections. Emergency exits must remain unobstructed, and dangerous buildings must be identified before tragedies occur.

Clean up Delhi's visual environment

Illegal posters, banners, hoardings and unauthorised advertisements have increasingly cluttered Delhi's roads and public spaces. The capital needs a strictly enforced outdoor advertising policy with designated spaces, digital permissions and penalties for violations. Its skyline and visual character deserve protection through consistent municipal enforcement.

Population growth needs planning

Economic opportunities continue to attract migrants to Delhi. The challenge is not migration itself but population growth without adequate housing, sanitation, transport and civic infrastructure. Better rental accommodation, worker housing, lawful tenant verification and reliable demographic information must guide future planning. Rehabilitation and redevelopment of JJ clusters also require coordinated implementation.

Ward-level accountability dashboard

Every municipal ward should publish regular information on unauthorised construction complaints, encroachment removal, restored footpaths, parking enforcement, safety inspections and grievance resolution. Citizens must know which officer is responsible, the deadline for action and whether their complaints have actually been resolved. Transparency can transform municipal accountability.

One complaint, one accountable officer

Citizens should not have to navigate multiple government departments to resolve civic problems. Delhi needs a unified grievance system based on one complaint, one tracking number, one responsible officer, one deadline and one closure report. Departments may coordinate internally, but administrative fragmentation must never become the citizen's burden.

A 100-day civic action plan

A 100-Day National Capital Civic Improvement Programme could provide a practical beginning. During the first 30 days, authorities should map and document unauthorised constructions, encroachments, illegal parking, dangerous buildings, pollution hotspots and traffic bottlenecks. Days 31-60 should focus on targeted enforcement, footpath restoration, parking regulation and safety inspections. During days 61-100, municipal agencies should introduce public accountability dashboards, officer-wise responsibilities and independent performance reviews. Every action should be documented publicly.

Delhi already has laws and regulations. What it lacks is consistent implementation, coordination and accountability. Making the capital clean, safe, accessible and environmentally responsible requires sustained commitment from government agencies, businesses, builders and citizens. Delhi stands at a crossroads. The question is whether India's capital can reclaim civic order before unchecked growth makes its problems increasingly difficult to reverse.

Views expressed are personal

Navigating the Digital Revolution

AI has transformed human possibilities, demanding stronger ethical judgment and responsibility

AI AND BEYOND



JOHN FELIX RAJ & PRABHAT KUMAR DATTA

JF RAJ IS THE VC, PK DATTA IS AN ADJUNCT PROFESSOR AT ST XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

Every few generations, a technology emerges that does far more than streamline our work–it fundamentally rewires how we think and perceive possibility. Artificial Intelligence is not magic; it is scale. It is a system built to digest vast oceans of data, uncover hidden patterns, and convert information into precise predictions. Yet, as AI moves from computer science laboratories into every sphere of human existence, we face a profound question: How do we navigate this revolution without losing our humanity?

The Mobile Phone Parallel and the AI-HI Synergy

We saw this exact pattern with the mobile phone revolution. Initially greeted with scepticism, mobile technology quickly achieved near-universal saturation. Yet, without conscious boundaries, it has also isolated us–turning quiet moments into screen time. Mobile phones proved that transformative technology will saturate society; the crucial question is whether we master the tool or allow the tool to master us.

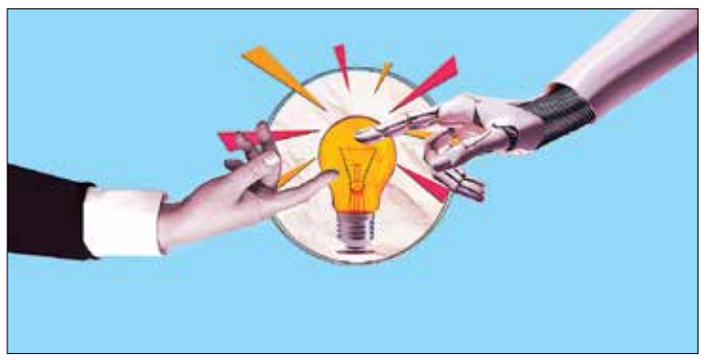
We find a wonderful illustration of partnership in the film Enthiran (2010), where the AI robot Chitti scans a thick telephone directory in seconds. This highlights the ideal synergy between Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Human Intelligence (HI). AI excels at processing vast structured data and zero-latency recall, while humans provide high-level context, ethical oversight, and emotional nuance. By offloading brute-force tasks to AI, humans can transcend mechanical labour to focus on critical thinking and strategy. AI serves as a powerful cognitive amplifier–fusing machine speed with human wisdom.

The Triad of Intelligence and Human Dignity

To understand our role, we must examine the hierarchy across three realms:

- **Divine Intelligence (DI):** The infinite, uncreated source of truth, existence, and moral order.
- **Human Intelligence (HI):** Endowed with free will, self-awareness, moral agency, and the capacity for love, acting as a co-creator.
- **Artificial Intelligence (AI):** A tool forged by human hands, possessing no soul or direct connection to the Divine.

When HI aligns with Divine Intelligence, technology becomes an instrument of justice and healing. When it forgets DI, AI risks becoming an echo-chamber of technological hubris. As Pope Leo XIV emphasises in his encyclical *Magnifica Humanitas,* machines lack moral conscience and relational depth. True wisdom belongs strictly to human intelligence. Global leaders must avoid reducing human life to algorithmic efficiency, ensuring technology serves the common good and human dignity.



The rise of intelligent machines has reinforced the importance of conscience and compassion

THE REAL CHALLENGE LIES IN MAKING AI SERVE HUMANITY'S GREATER GOOD

Animating AI through the Magis Principle

If St. Ignatius of Loyola, Founder of the Jesuit Order, were alive today, he would view AI as a powerful modern creatura–a tool to be utilised tantum quantum (insofar as it advances truth, human dignity, and the greater glory of God). In the Ignatian tradition, Magis–meaning "the More"–calls us to seek the greater good and fuller realisation of human dignity.

- **In Education:** As information becomes abundant, education must shift from merely accessing information to judging it. Drawing from the Guru-Shishya tradition and cura personalis (the care of the whole person), AI should free educators from routine grading and administration so they can focus on mentorship, character formation, and ethical reasoning. Assessments must evolve, so students learn not only how to use AI, but when to question it.
- **In Healthcare:** Combining diagnostic precision with the human touch. AI spots microscopic anomalies early, allowing clinicians to step away from screens and return to empathetic bedside care.
- **In Research & Pastoral Care:** Accelerating interdisciplinary breakthroughs while keeping human discernment central, and using data tools to organise relief efforts and communicate accessibly across language barriers.

The Next Frontier: Quantum Computing and Beyond

Looking beyond current architectures, the next evolutionary leap is the convergence of AI with *Quantum Computing*. Leveraging superposition and entanglement, quantum AI calculates vast arrays of possibilities simultaneously, promising to simulate complex molecular structures, optimise global supply chains, and solve multi-variable global crises. Yet, as computing power scales exponentially, the imperative for human ethics and the Magis becomes even more vital.

Conclusion: The Choice before Us

Tools do not possess morality; a hammer can construct or destroy, and fire can warm or consume. Similarly, AI can be used to concentrate power and spread misinformation–or it can cure diseases and democratize education.

If we guide technology with moral clarity, grounding AI in Human Intelligence and orienting both toward Divine Intelligence, AI will stand not as our replacement, but as a monument to human ingenuity. For education and society alike, this means building institutions that are neither AI-free nor AI-dependent, but AI-aware, ethically grounded, and human-centred–places where technology expands our capabilities while we retain the responsibility of interpretation, judgment, character, and care.

Views expressed are personal

AIR FORCE DAY CELEBRATIONS

IAF ready to meet any challenge, says Air Chief Marshal AP Singh

MPOST BUREAU
Ghaziabad, October 8

The Indian Air Force has transformed from a modest beginning in 1932 into an exceptional, network-centric and multi-domain force, and remains alert and prepared to confront any challenge, Air Chief Marshal A P Singh said on Thursday.

Addressing the Air Force Day celebrations at Hindan air base, the IAF chief said recent conflicts in different parts of the world had demonstrated that air power remained the primary means of safeguarding a nation's interests.

Referring to Operation Sindoor, Air Chief Marshal Singh said the IAF had demonstrated the "speed of combat operations" through its precision strike and air defence capabilities.

Air Force Day is observed on October 8 to mark the establishment of the IAF and commemorate the sacrifices made by air warriors.

Singh praised the contribution of air warriors in strengthening the force and asserted that the IAF was alert, committed and prepared to deal with any challenges.

"Our operational capabilities are growing in the right direction," he said, adding that the IAF would make every effort to meet the expectations placed upon it and strive to surpass them.

Recalling the force's proud legacy, the IAF chief called for maintaining an agile and combat-ready force.

"From four Wapiti aircraft, the force has evolved into an exceptional, capable, network-centric and multi-domain force ranked among the finest in the world," he said.

According to the IAF website, the force began with an "aircraft inventory" of four Westland Wapiti IIA army co-operation biplanes stationed at Drigh Road, which formed the nucleus of 'A' Flight of the planned No. 1 (Army Co-operation) Squadron.

The IAF currently has 29 fighter squadrons.

Reflecting on his retirement on October 31, Singh described his tenure as Chief of Air Staff as "my biggest fortune" and said it was a matter of great pride for him.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit will succeed him as the next Chief of Air Staff.



Chief of the Air Staff Air Chief Marshal AP Singh reviews the parade during the 94th Air Force Day celebrations at the Hindon Air Force Station, in Ghaziabad, Thursday PTI

IAF's 94th anniv: Ceremonial flypast in Varanasi on Oct 25

MPOST BUREAU
Ghaziabad, October 8

The Indian Air Force will hold a ceremonial aerial display over Namo Ghat in Varanasi on October 25 to mark its 94th anniversary, officials said on Thursday.

The announcement came after the IAF conducted its Air Force Day parade at Hindan Air Base, commemorating the force's establishment on October 8, 1932. The Varanasi flypast will be organised around the theme "Infallible, Impervious and Precise", the Defence Ministry said.

A senior official said the ceremonial flypast would follow the celebrations at Air Force Station Hindan and showcase the IAF's aerial capabilities. Last year, the IAF marked its 93rd anniversary with a spectacular flying display over the Brahmaputra in Guwahati, alongside the traditional parade at Hindan.

India condemns attacks on Saudi Arabia airports, advises nationals to stay vigilant

Indian Embassy in Riyadh asks Indian nationals to remain vigilant, stay indoors

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

India on Thursday strongly condemned the recent attacks on two airports in Saudi Arabia, calling the targeting of civilian infrastructure "completely unacceptable", and advised Indian nationals in the Gulf kingdom to remain alert amid the deteriorating security situation.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said attacks over the past few days targeted Abha International Airport and King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, resulting in civilian deaths and injuries.

"India condemns the attacks over the past few days targeting Abha International Airport and King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, which have resulted in civilian deaths and injuries," the MEA said.

THE MEA CONVEYED SOLIDARITY WITH THE PEOPLE AND GOVERNMENT OF SAUDI ARABIA

The ministry expressed condolences to the families of those killed and wished those injured a speedy recovery. It also conveyed solidarity with the people and government of Saudi Arabia.

Saudi authorities said two people were killed and 28 injured in the attack on Abha airport, while one person was killed and eight others wounded in the attack on King Khalid airport. The attacks have been attributed to Houthi militants.

The Indian Embassy in Riyadh issued a separate advisory asking Indian nationals to remain vigilant, stay indoors when necessary and follow instructions issued by Saudi authorities through official channels.

The embassy also advised Indians against circulating or reposting videos or news related to the ongoing developments. It said the embassy in Riyadh, the Consulate in Jeddah and their outsourced services through VFS were functioning normally.

The mission said its 24x7 Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendra helpline, 8002471234, remained available and urged the Indian community to follow the embassy's official social media handles for updates.

The security situation has also disrupted air services between India and Saudi Arabia. Air India and Air India Express have cancelled flights to and from Riyadh until October 10, while Akasa Air cancelled its Kochi-Riyadh and Riyadh-Kochi services on Thursday.

Air India Express said affected passengers could opt for complimentary rescheduling or a full refund. The airline operates 16 weekly Riyadh flights from Bengaluru, Kochi, Kannur and Kozhikode.

Air India, which operates seven weekly Riyadh flights from Delhi and Mumbai, has also cancelled its services until October 10. The airline said flight AI2243 from Delhi to Riyadh returned to the national capital on Thursday and was subsequently cancelled, with passengers offered full refunds.

West Asia, Persian Gulf conflicts kill 11 Indian seafarers: Govt

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

Conflicts in West Asia and the Persian Gulf region have claimed the lives of 11 Indian seafarers, Shipping Secretary Vijay Kumar said on Thursday.

Addressing a press conference here, Kumar said that the Indian government has repatriated 4,232 Indian seafarers safely from the Strait of Hormuz area.

Missile attacks on vessels have become rampant in parts of the Strait of Hormuz and the Persian Gulf area since the start of the US-Iran war on February 28, when the US and Israel attacked Iran, killing the country's supreme Leader Ayatollah Syed Ali Khamenei and several top commanders.

The Strait of Hormuz, a narrow choke point in West Asia, is a crucial shipping route that connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.

A senior shipping ministry official further said that conflicts in Black Sea have claimed the lives of five Indian seafarers since February 28.

The official further said that since February 28, 74 vessels of Indian interest have transited through the Strait of Hormuz, out of which 25 were Indian-flagged and the rest were foreign-flagged.

He also said that at present, eight Indian-flagged ships are in the Strait of Hormuz area, of which six are safely trading in that area, and two are container vessels.

DBT targets Rs 39.33L from e-waste, scrap disposal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8

The Department of Biotechnology (DBT) has set a target of freeing 46,486 square feet of usable office space and generating around Rs 39.33 lakh through the disposal of e-waste and other scrap during Special Campaign 6, being conducted from October 2 to 31.

As part of the preparatory phase from September 15 to 30, the department identified 18,741 e-files and 7,773 physical files for review. Cleaning and space-clearing activities were planned at 156 locations, along with the disposal of 1,694 e-waste items.

The campaign, being undertaken under the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DAR&PG), covers DBT's scientific cadre units, divisions, autonomous institutions and public sector undertakings.

The department observed Swachh Bharat Diwas on October 2 by organising an e-waste disposal drive at its headquarters in the CGO Complex. The drive was led by the DBT Secretary, who urged officers and staff to take individual responsibility for identifying and disposing of obsolete articles and unusable material at their workplaces and homes.

The Secretary said systematic disposal of outdated records and scrap could not only generate revenue for the exchequer but also create additional usable space in government offices.

Briefs

Suspended KPSC chairman arrested

BENGALURU: The Enforcement Directorate has arrested suspended KPSC chairman Shivashankarappa Sahukar and member B V Geetha in a money-laundering probe linked to alleged rigging of the recruitment exam for 400 Veterinary Officer posts. The ED alleged question papers and answer keys were leaked for bribes, with candidates allegedly paying Rs 20-40 lakh for advance access.

Sex racket busted in Mumbai

MUMBAI: Police busted an alleged sex racket operating under the guise of a spa centre in Borivali and rescued four women, an official said. Cashier Ankit Sanjaykumar Choubey was arrested and booked under relevant BNS and PITA provisions. Police seized Rs 21,000 cash, a mobile phone, card-swiping machine and catalogue.

Farmer ends life in Maha

BHANDARA: A 55-year-old farmer allegedly died by suicide in Maharashtra's Bhandara district amid crop failure and insufficient rainfall, officials said. Rajendra Sapate jumped into a well in his paddy field on Thursday morning. An accidental death case was registered and further investigation is underway.

CM Mann launches HUNAR Punjab portal

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 8

HE ALSO LAUNCHED 'FAST-TRACK PUNJAB' PORTAL FOR INVESTORS

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Thursday launched the 'HUNAR Punjab' and 'Fast-Track Punjab' portals, aimed at connecting industries with skilled youth, improving transparency and speeding up investment approvals.

Mann said the Fast-Track Punjab portal would enable investors to obtain necessary approvals through a single-window system within 45 days and transparently track financial incentives through its 'Passbook' module.

The HUNAR Punjab portal will bridge the gap between industries and skilled youth by providing hiring, placement, internship and industrial training opportunities. Around 1,750 institutions have already registered on the platform, with local skilled youth to be given preference for industrial employment, Mann said.

He said the portal would also facilitate industry-institute collaborations covering guest lectures, faculty development, on-job training, placements, curriculum inputs, infrastructure and technology support and CSR initiatives.

Mann said Punjab had attracted investment worth Rs 1.89 lakh crore since 2022, generating 6.31 lakh jobs. He attributed the inflow to investor confidence in the state's policies and business environment.

The chief minister said the government had implemented e-Office and online systems across departments to reduce delays and improve accountability.

"HUNAR Punjab is the skilling and placement pillar of Punjab's unified interface for industry, alongside Fast-Track Punjab," Mann said.

Hry CM pitches for one-time relief for old cases at GST Council meet

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 8



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday urged the GST Council to provide one-time relief for delayed appeals relating to the initial years of GST, improve coordination between Central and state tax authorities and restrict retrospective cancellation of GST registrations.

Saini made the suggestions while participating in the 57th meeting of the GST Council chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.

Highlighting Haryana's GST performance, Saini said the state collected Rs 10,097 crore in gross GST in September 2026, the fifth-highest among states and more than seven per cent of the country's domestic GST collection.

He sought another opportunity to file appeals against orders for 2017-18 to 2019-20, noting that 646 cases in Haryana involving Rs 567.43 crore had been rejected solely because of delays. He said the proposed relief should cover demands relating to tax, interest and penalty, including cases involving only interest or penalty.

Saini also proposed a technology-based mechanism to coordinate enforcement actions by Central and state GST authorities, saying taxpayers should not have to repeatedly submit documents in interconnected investigations.

On retrospective cancellation of registration, he suggested that registrations should not be cancelled for periods where evidence shows the taxpayer had actually made supplies, as such action could also affect input tax credit claimed by genuine buyers.

Welcoming proposed GST reforms, Saini supported greater use of automation and technology in registration, cancellation, amendments and refunds, along with simplified registration for small taxpayers supplying through e-commerce operators.

He said Haryana's State GST revenue, including its share of IGST settlement, rose 22 per cent to Rs 48,289 crore in 2025-26 from Rs 39,743 crore, compared with six per cent nationally. In the first six months of the current fiscal, revenue grew 26 per cent to Rs 29,108 crore.

Gomti water inundates parts of Lucknow

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 8

Rising water levels in the Gomti River have triggered a flood-like situation in parts of Lucknow, with water inundating the service lane along Shaheed Path leading towards Phoenix Palassio Mall.

The river level on Wednesday reached 107.24 metres against the danger mark of 108.5 metres, disrupting traffic in Gomti Nagar and adjoining areas.

The Lucknow Municipal Corporation stepped up rescue and relief operations, shifting 35 families to safer locations and providing shelters, water tankers and packaged drinking water. Around 90 boats were deployed for rescue and relief work.

Municipal Commissioner Gaurav Kumar inspected affected areas and reviewed sanitation and disease-prevention measures.

'El Nino to continue to intensify ahead of its forecast peak in Dec'

This likely to bring above-average temperatures to much of the globe and different regions: WMO

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 8

The World Meteorological Organization (WMO) on Thursday said that the prevailing El Nino conditions over the equatorial Pacific would continue to intensify ahead of its forecast peak in December.

This is likely to bring above-average temperatures to much of the globe and different regions, according to WMO's latest monthly global seasonal climate update.

In a statement, WMO Secretary-General Celeste Saulo said, "El Nino is firmly established and strengthening rapidly. WMO forecasts indicate a near-100 per cent likelihood that it will persist through February 2027, potentially being one of the strongest since at least 1950."

El Nino is one of the three phases of the El Nino Southern Oscillation (ENSO) -- a climate phenomenon characterised by changes in sea temperatures along the central and eastern tropical Pacific Ocean, accompanied by fluctuations in the atmosphere overhead.

While El Nino, which leads to less monsoon rainfall in India, is known to have a warming effect over the planet, its opposite phase, La Nina, usually results in a cooling effect. ENSO also has a neutral phase.

Note that the prevailing El Nino conditions are one of the key reasons why India received 87.4 per cent of the long period average (LPA) rainfall this southwest monsoon season (June-September).

While normal rainfall during the monsoon season is 868.6 mm, this year it was 759.4 mm over India.

As El Nino conditions continue to strengthen, they could have severe effects on India and its population and ecology. These include widespread bleaching and mortality of coral, an increase in wildfires, and the death of large rainforest trees.

There is also a high probability of drought and extreme heat conditions, which could be catastrophic for India's farmers, fishers and shepherds as well.



REPERESENTATIVE PIC

KEY POINTS

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- The prevailing El Nino conditions are one of the key reasons why India received 87.4 per cent of the long period average rainfall this southwest monsoon season
- While normal rainfall during the monsoon season is 868.6 mm, this year it was 759.4 mm over India

News at a glance

Palestinian factions move to delay first elections in 20 years

BEIRUT: Palestinian factions are discussing postponing legislative elections that had been planned for November, officials said Thursday.

A top official with the Hamas-allied Islamic Jihad group said the factions had reached an agreement to delay the vote, which is facing huge logistical issues in Israeli-annexed east Jerusalem and war-ravaged Gaza, as well as the long history of internal feuding among the Palestinians. A spokesperson for Fatah, stopped short of confirming that a final decision had been reached.

Eritrean forces seen entering towns in Ethiopia's Tigray

MEKELLE: Eritrean soldiers have entered two towns in northern Ethiopia, a commander allied with Ethiopia's government said, as residents reported that Tigrayan opposition forces had withdrawn from Shire, a major town in northwestern Tigray.

Ermiyas Ababu, a Tigray Peace Force commander based in Mekelle, said Eritrean personnel entered Adigrat on Tuesday and Idaga Hamus on Wednesday. Citing reports from his personnel in the area, he said Eritrean officers and commanders were conducting surveillance in Idaga Hamus.

Pak: 25 terror groups are operating in Afghanistan

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi on Thursday told UN Secretary General Antonio Guterres that 25 terrorist organisations were operating in Afghanistan and called for international cooperation to tackle the threat, according to a government statement.

His remarks came amid heightened tensions between Pakistan and Afghanistan, with Islamabad accusing the Taliban government of allowing militants, including the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), to operate from Afghan territory.



People carrying Israeli flags walk through an installation marking the third anniversary of the Oct 7 attack on Israel, on the beachfront in Tel Aviv AP/PTI

'Philippine's Rodrigo Duterte fit to stand ICC trial'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
The Hague, October 8

Judges at the International Criminal Court have ruled that former Philippine President Rodrigo Duterte is fit to stand trial on charges of crimes against humanity linked to the so-called war on drugs he waged while in office, the court announced Thursday.

Duterte, 81, denies the charges. His trial is scheduled to open on November 30.

The ex-leader is accused of murder and attempted murder for his alleged involvement in dozens of killings as part of the war on drugs.

The court's Sept 28 ruling that he is fit to face justice came after an independent panel of experts said that Duterte "has the capacity to understand the charges," and follow the proceedings including implications of entering a plea -- which he will be asked to do when the trial opens, the court said in a statement.

PREZ APPEALED FOR ADDITIONAL DEFENCE SUPPORT FROM NATO

Strike on Ukrainian public bus leaves 30 dead as blackouts worsen in Kyiv

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 8

Thirty people were killed and at least 18 were injured by Russian strikes in eastern Ukraine that included an attack on a public bus, authorities said Thursday, as an intensive pre-winter wave of attacks continued and power outages worsened in the capital Kyiv.

Vadym Filashkin, head of the regional military administration, said public transport in Kramatorsk and the neighbouring city of Sloviansk, in Ukraine's Donetsk region, was halted because of the sharp deterioration in security.

He accused Russia of deliberately targeting civilians, adding: "In such circumstances, we have no right to risk the lives of passengers and drivers. The safety of residents of Kramatorsk and Sloviansk is above all."

The attacks follow deadly missile strikes a day earlier in the northern Ukrainian town of Pryluky, where the death toll rose to 22, including five children. Rescuers searched through the rubble of a residential building hit by a Russian missile and at least 54 people were injured.

Heavy debris was removed from the cratered section of the building, while rescue dogs continued a search nearby for residents who have not yet been accounted for.



Representational Image

HIGHLIGHTS

- **The attacks follow deadly missile strikes a day earlier in the northern Ukrainian town of Pryluky**
- **Several survivors of the attack were forced to sleep in heavily damaged apartments after they couldn't find anywhere else to sleep**

Several survivors of the attack were forced to sleep in heavily damaged apartments after they couldn't find anywhere else to sleep. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned that Russia will likely escalate daily missile and drone attacks as winter approaches. He appealed for additional defence support from NATO countries.

"It is important that support in words takes concrete form in new packages for Ukraine's defence," he wrote in an online post. "Supplies of anti-ballistic capabilities, ammunition for our combat aircraft, and investments in interceptors -- all of this is directly helping save lives every day."

Ukraine grapples with shortage of troops after over four years of war

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 8



Representational Image

Ukraine's advances in drone technology and tactics have captured the world's attention. Despite those innovations, one problem has plagued the country since the start of Russia's invasion: a shortage of combat-ready troops.

Ukraine has always been outmanned by Russia, but as the war drags through its fifth year, the need for personnel is increasingly acute, commanders and analysts say, with some units at only half strength. There just aren't enough forces to fully exploit the battlefield advantages resulting from the drone innovations.

"Based on the equipment and the number of people we have today, we barely haveenough to hold the sector we currently have," said a deputy commander of the Da Vinci Wolves battalion in eastern Ukraine's Pokrovsk area, a focus of Russia's offensive.

"To move forward would inevitably mean greater losses," said the deputy commander, who insisted on identifying himself only as "Afer" because of military rules.

Long-standing mobilisation problems, including draft dodging and desertion, make it harder for Ukraine to build its reserves, according to military experts, resulting in only incremental changes along the 1,250-kilometre (775-mile) front line.

Otherwise, commanders have fewer options to turn a temporary advantage into a sustained operation, said Nick Reynolds of the UK-based Royal United Services Institute, a defense and security think tank.

Canadian poet, essayist Anne Carson wins Nobel Prize in literature

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Stockholm, October 8

Canadian poet, essayist and translator Anne Carson won the Nobel Prize in literature Thursday for playful, genre-blending works that fuse the classical and the modern.

The Toronto-born Carson, 76, draws on themes and stories from ancient Greek and Roman literature for writing that often blends elements of poetry, essay and fiction.

The permanent secretary of the Swedish Academy said the author was in Iceland "listening to the wind" when the academy reached her to notify her of the win. "She was very taken by surprise," Ingrid Carlberg said. Carson is among the more high-profile recent winners of the literature Nobel, which often honours authors little known outside of the literary world and is sometimes criticised for valuing literary experimentation over the ability to connect with a broad readership.

CARSON IS AMONG THE MORE HIGH-PROFILE RECENT WINNERS OF THE LITERATURE NOBEL

However, the prize can also introduce readers to writers and works beyond their own languages or reading habits.

Carson's books include "Eros the Bittersweet," a look at the pleasure and pain of desire in ancient Greek literature, the verse novel "Autobiography of Red," as well as "Men in the Off Hours," a collection of poetry and prose that won Canada's Griffin Prize for poetry in 2001, and "Norma Jeane Baker of Troy," which compares Marilyn Monroe and Helen of Troy.

Majority of people in Myanmar living in poverty or at risk: UN

Almost 18 mn people, or 32.6% of the population, are poor, while another 19.5 mn are vulnerable to poverty

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Bangkok, October 8

More than two in three people living in Myanmar are either in poverty or at risk of falling into it, as armed conflict, limited access to basic services and economic instability deepen deprivation across the country, a United Nations report published on Thursday said.

Almost 18 million people, or 32.6 per cent of the population, are poor, while another 19.5 million are vulnerable to poverty, according to the UN Development Program (UNDP).



That brings the total number of people in or at risk of poverty to over 37 million people, or 68 per cent of the population.

Myanmar has been in turmoil since the military seized power from the elected government of Aung San Suu Kyi in 2021, triggering widespread opposition. After security forces suppressed peaceful protests with lethal force, many opponents of military rule took up arms, plunging large parts of the country into conflict.

Kanni Wignaraja, UN assistant secretary-general and UNDP regional director for Asia and the Pacific, said: "We are seeing a depth of poverty in Myanmar that is eroding human development itself. This is a no-win war. Everyone is losing. The core muscle of the country is being systematically eroded."

The UNDP report was based on a nationwide telephone survey of 7,463 households. It used an adapted Multidimensional Poverty Index that captures deprivation beyond income, including overlapping gaps in health, education and living standards.

Deficits in health and living standards account for more than 80 per cent of measured poverty, the report said, reflecting difficulties accessing health care, adequate housing, clean water, sanitation and other essential services, particularly in conflict zones.

Poverty is especially widespread and severe in states facing heightened insecurity and restricted access, particularly Rakhine in the west and Kayah in the east, it said.

Low levels of education, insecure employment and low incomes compound pressures from conflict, displacement, disrupted markets and fragmented services, driving deprivation across Myanmar, the report found.

Repeated economic and natural hazard shocks further deepen poverty, with El Nino expected to intensify those pressures. The naturally occurring climatic pattern can disrupt rainfall and raise global temperatures.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: 8420262027 Date: 05.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **13:30** hrs. on **28.10.2026.** The details of the tenders are as under:-

S N	Tender No.	Approx. Cost of work (Rs.)	Bid Security (Rs.)
1	179	7,82,30,509.10	15,64,600.00

Name of work: Combined tender- (A) DDU-PRYJ:- Improvement of RUB/LHS no. **09, 14, 16, 25, 1C, 120C, 123C, 124C** for protection from water seepage works under Sr. DEN/I/PRYJ. **(B)** CAR-CPU:- Improvement of RUB/LHS no. **9C, 14C, 20C, 21C, 22C, 120A** & **85B** for protection from water seepage and other miscellaneous works under ADEN/CAR.

2	180	6,30,06,472.36	12,60,100.00

Name of work: Pre and post BCM work and other associated P. Way works in section of Sr. DEN/I/PRYJ.

Completion period: For SN. 1 to 2- 12 months, **Date of Opening of tender: For SN. 1 to 2-** 28.10.2026, **Similar work for Eligibility Criteria : For SN. 1-** Seepage protection or strengthening of Bridges/Tunnels/Reservoirs/Any Important civil engineering structures by Cement/Epoxy grouting or by hydro reactive Polyurethane (PU) resin grouting or by any advanced method used for seepage protection & **For SN. 2-** Any P.Way work.

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders is available on website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **13:30** hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e **28.10.2026.** The tender shall be opened at or after 15:00 hrs on due date of opening. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. **(3)** Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. **(4) Tender Nos. 179 to 180** are having advertised value more than **50 Lakhs,** therefore, Annexure-V & V(A) (Document Verification Certificate) is required. The supplier / contractor of goods and / or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. **(5)** This tender notice has also been uploaded on **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. (6)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. **(7)** Tender online can be submitted up to **13:30** hrs. on **28.10.2026. (8)** E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **(9) For tender nos. 179 to 180: The tenderers have to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of IRGCC-2022 (Works matter) mandatorily, otherwise their offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered.** 2283/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

4 astronauts return to Earth after 8 months

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cape Canaveral, October 8

Four astronauts returned to Earth from the International Space Station on Thursday after hurrying there eight months ago to replace an ailing colleague and his crew.

SpaceX brought the US, French and Russian flyers back with a splashdown in the Pacific off the coast of Los Angeles.

NASA's Jessica Meir and Jack Hathaway, France's Sophie Adenot and Russia's Andrey Fedyaev departed the orbiting lab on Wednesday, eager to reunite with their families after a lengthy separation.

Their replacements arrived three weeks late because of capsule repairs, stalling this crew's homecoming.

They couldn't wait to feel the breeze on their faces, hit the shower and, for Adenot at least, plunge back into water sports.

"It's a lot of mixed, swirling emotions for all of us," Meir said.

China announces candidate for WHO chief position

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Beijing, October 8

China has nominated a senior public health official for the post of Director-General of the World Health Organization, Beijing confirmed on Thursday, a move that could bring renewed global attention to China's handling of the COVID-19 pandemic and the unresolved question of the virus's origins.

DR SONG LI ALSO HAS EXPERIENCE IN HANDLING OTHER HEALTH EMERGENCIES, INCLUDING SARS OUTBREAK IN 2002

Dr Song Li, a senior official of China's National Health Commission, has worked for more than two decades in maternal and child health and international health cooperation.

She played a major role in coordinating measures to protect pregnant women, newborns and children and in maintaining essential maternal and child healthcare services, according to her official profile.

कार्यालय नगर पालिका परिषद भिण्ड, जिला–भिण्ड (म.प्र.)

क्रमांक/ई–टण्डसिंग/निर्माण/2026/594 भिण्ड, दिनांक 6-10-2026

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

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समस्त केन्द्रीयकृत पंजयीनधारी ठेकेदारों को एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि नगरपालिका परिषद भिण्ड का निम्नांकित कार्य के लिये एम.पी.ई.बी. के चालू एस.ओ.आर. से प्रतिशत दर आधार पर **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क.	निविदा आमंत्रण का प्रकार	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत	धरोहर राशि	निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क	ठेकेदार की श्रेणी	कार्य अवधि
1	III rd call	निकाय क्षेत्रांतर्गत बस स्टेण्ड से भूरा मठी तक रोड के बीचों–बीच आये 33 के. व्ही.11 के.वी.. डीटीआर एण्ड एलटी लाइन शिफ्टिंग कराने का कार्य	6263616/-	47000/-	10000/-	मुख्य अभियंता विद्युत सुरक्षा म.प्र. में पंजीकृत "ए" श्रेणी ठेकेदार/कन्द्रीयकृत पी.डब्ल्यू.डी. में विद्युत कार्य हेतु रजिस्ट्रेशन	2 माह

शर्तें:–

1. टेण्डर फार्म दिनांक 05.10.2026 समय 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 21.10.2026 को समय 17:30 बजे तक ऑनलाइन कय किये जा सकते है।
2. निविदाएं (Bid submission end date) दिनांक 21.10.2026 समय 17:30 बजे तक ऑनलाइन प्रस्तुत की जा सकती हैं;
3. प्राप्त निविदाओं का Mandatory Submission Envelope-Aदिनांक 23.10.2026 को समय दोपहर 12:30 बजे के बाद खोला जायेगा तथा Financial Bid Envelope-C दिनांक 23.10.2026 को 15:00 बजे के बाद खोला आवेगा।

निविदा संबंधी विस्तृत जानकारी **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर या कार्यालयीन समय में कार्यालय की निर्माण शाखा से प्राप्त की जा सकती है

वर्षा अमित वाल्मीकि
अध्यक्ष
नगरपालिका परिषद **भिण्ड, जिला**– भिण्ड (म. प्र)

वीरेन्द्र चकवर्ती
मुख्य नगरपालिका अधिकारी
नगरपालिका परिषद **भिण्ड, जिला**– भिण्ड (म. प्र)

'INDIA'S AUTHORISATION REGIME FAIR, NON-DISCRIMINATORY'

Govt rejects Starlink's claims, says all satcom cos face same security process

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



KEY POINTS

- The government has licensed three companies - Musk's Starlink, Reliance Jio's satellite venture Jio Satcom and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb
- However, none can begin commercial services until required security assessments and spectrum-related approvals are completed

India on Thursday rejected Elon Musk's allegation that Starlink's satellite internet services were being blocked by domestic business interests, saying all satellite communications companies were subject to the same regulatory and security requirements.

The telecom ministry said the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services was "fair and non-discriminatory" and called any suggestion that it was being applied selectively "baseless and misconceived.

The government has licensed three companies - Musk's Starlink, Reliance Jio's satellite venture Jio Satcom and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb - but none can begin commercial services until required security assessments and spectrum-related approvals are completed.

"Security assessment as part of this process is currently under way in respect of all three licensees," the telecom ministry said in a statement. Minister of State for Communications Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani said the issue was with the Ministry of Home Affairs and was not specific to any one company.

"The Department of Telecom has issued licences to all satcom companies as well as provisional spectrum. Now the issue is pending with MHA for security clearance. As soon as it is cleared, they will get it. It has nothing to do with one company," Pemmasani told reporters on the sidelines of the India Mobile Congress.

The comments came a day after Musk alleged on X that "certain oligarchs" were blocking Starlink to protect a "monopolistic chokehold" on the Indian market. He did not identify any company.

Musk also rejected claims that Starlink services had been used by militants in Manipur, saying its satellite beams were switched off over India and therefore could not have been used for any purpose there.

"Starlink in India would enable high-speed, affordable internet connectivity for those who can't afford current prices or who don't have a connection at all!" Musk said in another post.

India's telecom market is dominated by Reliance Jio, Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea, while satellite broadband represents a new potential segment that could extend connectivity to remote & underserved areas.

Bharti Airtel Chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal, whose group backs OneWeb, said his own satellite venture was also waiting for regulatory approvals. "We are waiting for our own approvals," Mittal said at the India Mobile Congress when asked about Musk's allegations.

Jio Platforms MD Akash Ambani declined to comment, saying he had not seen Musk's remarks.

The government's response comes as the India Mobile Congress, is under way in New Delhi. Under the government's framework, a licensed satellite operator can move to the spectrum-assignment stage once it completes the required security process. The telecom ministry said all three licensees were currently "broadly at the same regulatory stage."

Within hours of the government's rebuttal, Musk in an X post asked whether "Ambani is the real boss of India". "Starlink is licensed in over 165 countries and has spent five years complying with every single law and requirement of the government of India, so why still no license?.

"Is Ambani the real boss of India?" Musk said in an X post. The assertion came within hours of the telecom ministry saying that the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services was "fair and non-discriminatory" and that any suggestion that it was being applied selectively was "baseless and misconceived".

SAFETY, DEEPFAKES KEY FOCUS AREAS

Consultation paper on AI norms in a month: IT Minister Vaishnaw

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw

The government will bring out a consultation paper on AI regulations in a month, dealing with aspects like AI safety, a human-first approach, and deepfakes, Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Thursday, adding that the time for such a framework has come, and that industry must shoulder the bulk of the responsibility.

The move assumes significance as concerns over deepfakes, cyber threats and the psychological effects of AI chatbots are growing, and leading researchers have repeatedly called for stronger safeguards. Across the world, governments and regulators are racing to keep pace with fast-moving AI, with the European Union already enacting a comprehensive AI Act.

Vaishnaw noted that deepfakes are a "nuisance which can cause huge problems in society", and added that their quality is improving every day.

"People believe them, and it sets a totally wrong precedent. It sets a totally wrong narrative, and people get lured into doing wrong things and believing wrong things," he said, adding the upcoming consultation paper would deal with AI harms and deepfakes as a big area of focus.

"I'll request the department to come out with a regulation-focused consultation paper, which focuses on safety. That's the most important point...safety-related to AI use," Vaishnaw said while speaking at an event on the release of the World Development Report.

The India Launch of the World Development Report 2026: The Promise of Artificial Intelligence was organised by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), through the IndiaAI Mission, in collaboration with the World Bank Group.

Vaishnaw further said that the upcoming consultation paper will form the basis for AI regulations, and added that thetime has come for India to have such a framework.

Other issues that the consultation paper would prioritise are AI harms, including deepfakes, a human-first approach, skilling, as well as a commitment to leave no person behind, the Minister elaborated.

"Humanity has to be the most important part of change that has happened," Vaishnaw said.

Government has always maintained that AI and other technologies cannot be regulated by law alone, he said, adding, "We have to bring a techno-legal solution.

Vaishnaw made it clear that the industry must shoulder the bulk of the responsibility. "The industry has to take the primary responsibility," he said, listing out issues such as cybersecurity, safety, user harm, psychological disorders and deepfakes. "So we'll come out with that paper in a month's time from now, and based on that we'll go forward with the regulation," Vaishnaw said.

Briefs

Rupee falls 13 paise to 96.88/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated by 13 paise to close at 96.88 against the US dollar on Thursday, on risk aversion in global markets amid escalation of geopolitical tensions.

At the interbank forex market, rupee opened at 96.71 against the US dollar & traded in range of 96.65-96.79, before settling at 96.88, down 13 paise over its previous close.

Airtel hikes postpaid plans by ₹50

NEW DELHI: Bharti Airtel has hiked postpaid tariffs by Rs 50 across all six plans from October 8, 2026, while offering one free annual international roaming trip. Existing subscribers will be shifted to the nearest higher plan within a month, company sources said.

Hike ranges from 3-11%, with Rs 449 plan moving to Rs 499 postpaid plan & Rs 1,749 plan to Rs 1,799. Roaming pack includes 5 GB data, 60 minutes of calls, 25 outgoing SMS.

Reserve Bank's 29-day VRRR auction receives tepid response

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 8

The RBI's 29-day variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction received a tepid response on Thursday, even though banking system liquidity is in a huge surplus.

However, the central bank's second VRRR auction, with a one-day maturity, received a good response, reflecting banks' reluctance to park money with the RBI for a longer tenure.

The central bank received bids worth Rs 79,655 crore for the 29-day VRRR auction against a notified amount of Rs 2 lakh crore, which it accepted fully at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.49 per cent.

The overnight VRRR auction received bids worth Rs 1,60,664 crore for a notified amount of Rs 2 lakh crore. The RBI accepted the entire amount offered during the auction at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.49 per cent.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in a surplus of around Rs 4.24 lakh crore as of October 4, according to RBI data.

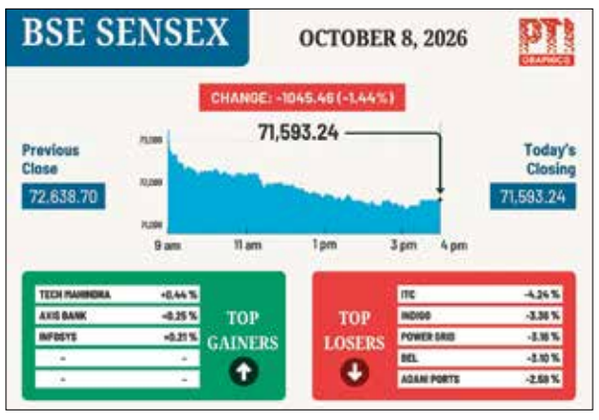
During August and September, system liquidity increased substantially due to the recent measures undertaken to attract capital inflows. As measured by the net position under the LAF, system liquidity averaged a daily surplus of Rs 5.9 lakh crore since the last MPC meeting in August 2026.

The average daily net absorption under the LAF increased from Rs 1.2 lakh crore in July 2026 to Rs 5.8 lakh crore in August and further to Rs 7.8 lakh crore in September.

The RBI conducted 55 variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auctions, including 2 term VRRR auctions and OMO sales amounting to Rs 1 lakh crore since the August 2026 policy, the RBI said.

Sensex tanks 1,045 pts, Nifty slips to 21-month low on selling in rate-sensitive stocks, oil surge

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 8



Benchmark stock index Sensex tanked 1,045 points while Nifty slid to a 21-month low on Thursday following heavy selling in rate-sensitive, commodities and FMCG shares amid a sharp spike in crude oil prices and growing prospect of tighter domestic and global monetary conditions.

Falling for the second day running, the 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 1,045.46 points, or 1.44 per cent, to settle at a more than two-and-a-half-year low of 71,593.24.

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies eroded by Rs 10,01,898.68 crore to Rs 4,60,97,032 crore ($4.76 trillion) in a single day.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 371.25 points, or 1.64 per cent, to end at a 21-month low of 22,231.80.

From the 30 Sensex firms, ITC was the biggest loser, down by 4.24 per cent. InterGlobe Aviation dropped 3.36 per cent, Power Grid by 3.16 per cent, Bharat Electronics by 3.1 per cent, Adani Ports by 2.59 per cent and NTPC by 2.43 per cent. Tech Mahindra, Axis Bank and Infosys were the winners. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 4.25 per cent to $104.5 per barrel.

All BSE sectoral indices ended lower. Power slumped 3.51 per cent, Metal 3.34 per cent, Utilities 3.38 per cent, Realty 3.07 per cent, Capital Goods 3.02 per cent, Industrials 2.93 per cent, Services 2.76 per cent & Commodities 2.71 per cent. A total of 3,426 stocks declined, 1,003 advanced & 225 remained unchanged on the BSE.

Avg GST rate declines to 10.84% post rationalisation

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 8

The average GST rate has fallen to 10.84 per cent after the goods and services tax rates were rationalised in September last year from 11.4 per cent in 2023, sources said. At the time of the launch of GST on July 1, 2017, the revenue neutral rate (RNR) was calculated at 15.8 per cent.

In September, the GST Council rationalised the indirect tax regime by collapsing the four-slab GST structure of 5, 12, 18, and 28 per cent into a two-slab structure of 5 and 18 per cent. Also, there was a 40 per cent rate for sin and luxury goods.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said despite the rate cuts announced in September, GST revenues have grown.

In the first six months of FY27, GST collections grew 11.6 per cent to Rs 12.46 lakh crore. Sitharaman also said the GST Council did not discuss GST to be levied on Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) UPI transactions above Rs 2,000.

SBI Funds Management, Amundi launch India Investment Seminar

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 8

SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM) and Amundi on Thursday inaugurated the India Investment Seminar 2026 in Mumbai, bringing together over 100 international institutional investors and Amundi clients to explore India's growth story and investment opportunities.

The two-day seminar, themed "Experience the Indian Growth Story", enables global investors to engage with policymakers, industry leaders and investment professionals.

Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran discussed India's ambition of becoming a developed economy by 2047, while SBI Chairman C S Setty highlighted the financial system's role in economic growth and inclusion. Setty said SBIFM has 13.2 Trillion AUM, while its subsidiaries are driving financial inclusion across banking & financial services.

Amitabh Kant discussed India's manufacturing opportunity amid shifting global supply chains, while Maruti Suzuki's Rahul Bharti shared insights from its four-decade journey.

The seminar also examined FDI, infrastructure financing, GIFT IFSC and international capital flows.

Speakers included Nivruti Rai, MD & CEO, Invest India and representatives from NIIF, Cube Highways and CPPIB. Discussions on October 9 will cover monetary policy, consumption, digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence, clean energy and investment management.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Dr. K Krishna Kumar, Director General/Railway Health Services, Railway Board, conducted a detailed inspection of Lala Lajpat Rai Hospital at the Rail Coach Factory (RCF) Kapurthala on Thursday. He reviewed the medical facilities being provided to railway employees and their families in presence of Principal Chief Medical Officer Dr. Latha Ramalingam, Dr. Rajesh Mohan, Dr. Jaideep Titoria, Dr. Pramod Kumar.



The West Bengal Power Development Corporation Limited (WBPDCL) has been awarded the 'TOP MOST ORGANIZATIONS WITH INNOVATIVE HR PRACTICES' by EIILM-Kolkata at The Eastern India Leadership Awards (10th edition) on Thursday.

Govt should withdraw proposed UPI charges, says GTRI

'Charging merchants could raise prices, squeeze small business earnings & weaken household demand'

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 8

CLOSER LOOK

- An independent audit should establish and publish UPI's actual running costs, GTRI Founder Ajay Srivastava said
- An MDR would reduce the benefit merchants receive from free UPI payments and make cards more competitive, he said

The government should withdraw proposed UPI charges scheduled to take effect on October 15 and keep the digital payment system free for merchants and consumers, economic think tank GTRI said on Thursday.

GTRI Founder Ajay Srivastava said charging merchants could raise prices, squeeze small business earnings and weaken household demand. An independent audit should establish and publish UPI's actual running costs, he said. The government has introduced a 0.4 per cent fee on merchant transfers above Rs 2,000 from October 15, ending nearly six years of fully free UPI payments. Person-to-person transactions and small payments will remain exempt.

Srivastava said banks save on cash handling and ATM and branch operations through UPI, while payment apps gain customer spending data and opportunities to sell loans, insurance and mutual funds in a market serving more than 55 crore Indians.

The government also benefits from wider digital payments and greater visibility of economic transactions, he said, arguing these benefits justify sharing UPI's running costs among stakeholders to preserve its price advantage over cards. PhonePe & Google Pay, which together handle more than 80 per cent of UPI transactions, could earn a share of merchant fees, Srivastava said.

He warned that Visa and Mastercard could benefit if UPI loses its price advantage. An MDR would reduce the benefit merchants receive from free UPI payments and make cards more competitive, he said.

Srivastava also urged India to resist US pressure to weaken UPI, citing Brazil's defence of its domestic Pix digital-payment system. He said UPI's affordability and widespread acceptance are economic strengths.

Annual UPI payment value exceeded 91 per cent of India's GDP last year, highlighting its reach. Proposed fees could affect the broader economy, he said.

Higher prices would leave households with less money for other purchases, while farmers, vendors and businesses could absorb the cost through lower earnings where competition prevents price increases.

Weaker earnings and demand could prompt firms to cut inventories, postpone investment and hire fewer workers, he added. He said keeping UPI free would protect consumers, support small businesses and preserve India's competitive edge in digital payments.

News at a glance

JSW Steel production jumps 5% to 7.27 MT in Sept quarter

NEW DELHI: JSW Steel on Thursday said its consolidated crude steel production rose 5 per cent to 7.27 million tonnes (MT) in the September quarter of FY27, from 6.95 MT in the year-ago period.

Production at its Indian operations increased 5 per cent year-on-year to 7.07 million tonnes. Capacity utilisation stood at 88 per cent during July-September FY27 and improved to about 90 per cent in September 2026, following the gradual ramp-up of Blast Furnace 3 at Vijayanagar after capacity upgradation. Consolidated H1 production rose 4 per cent to 13.86 MT from 13.32 MT.

TCS Sept quarter net profit jumps 15% to ₹13,884 crore

MUMBAI: Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) on Thursday reported a 15 per cent rise in net profit to Rs 13,884 crore for the September quarter, from Rs 12,075 crore a year ago and Rs 13,349 crore in the preceding quarter.

Revenue from operations increased 11.22 per cent to Rs 73,188 crore from Rs 65,799 crore, compared with Rs 72,275 crore in June quarter.

Annualised AI revenues rose to $ 3 billion from $2.6 billion. TCS added 4,258 employees, taking headcount to 5,98,056. The board recommended a dividend of Rs 12 per share.

I-T dept moves ITAT against tax relief to Dr Lal PathLabs

NEW DELHI: The Income Tax Department has challenged before the Income Tax Appellate Tribunal (ITAT), New Delhi, the tax relief granted to Dr Lal PathLabs on an expense of Rs 32.66 cr, the diagnostic services provider said on Thursday.

In a regulatory filing, the company said it received an intimation on Wednesday regarding the appeal filed against an order passed by the Commissioner of Income Tax (Appeals) for Assessment Year 2022-23 under Section 250 of the Income Tax Act, 1961. The order granted relief against disallowance of ESOP expenses amounting to Rs 32,66,18,927.

Vedanta declares first interim dividend of ₹5 post-demerger

NEW DELHI: Vedanta Ltd on Thursday declared its first interim dividend post-demerger of Rs 5 per share for FY27, amounting to about Rs 1,955 crore.

In an exchange filing, the company said its board approved the dividend on October 08, 2026, on equity shares with a face value of Rs 1 per share. The record date is October 14, 2026, and payment will be made within the prescribed timelines.

In 2025-26, Vedanta declared Rs 34 per share through three interim dividends, following Rs 43.50 per share in 2024-25. The company reported record production across key operations in Q2 FY27.

INDIANS ACCOUNT FOR OVER 70% OF H-1B APPROVALS ANNUALLY

US suspends Cognizant, Infosys, TCS, Wipro, HCL from Green Card process

'The Department of Labour is also suspending Microsoft and Adobe from the programme due to multiple active federal investigations'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, October 8

The US on Thursday suspended eight IT firms, including Microsoft, Tata, Infosys and Wipro, from a programme to apply for green cards for foreign workers, contending that the practice has shut out Americans from the job market.

The announcement was made by Vice President J D Vance, Labour Secretary Keith Sonderling, and Attorney General Todd Blanche as part of the action under the aegis of the US Anti-Fraud Task Force.

"I am hereby suspending from the Permanent Labour Certification Programme some of the largest IT outsourcing firms in the world, Cognizant, Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL, and Capgemini," Sonderling said.

He said the Department of Labour is also suspending Microsoft and Adobe from the programme due to multiple active federal investigations.

"There has been no company in the United States, unfortunately, that has abused this system more than Microsoft," Vance said.



'THEY'VE RECEIVED OVER 230,000 H-1B VISA APPROVALS & OVER 100,000 PERMANENT LABOUR CERTIFICATIONS,', SONDERLING SAID

"Microsoft laid off 6,000 American workers in 2025 after certifying that it could not find qualified American employees - yet the company was approved for more than 6,000 H-1Bs and filed 3,682 PERM applications, including nearly 1,000 applications for the same positions as the laid off American workers," the vice president said.

Sonderling said the Department of Labour will not accept any new or process any pending permanent labour certification applications involving these companies.

"Since 2009, just these companies alone have requested almost three million foreign workers. They've received over 230,000 H-1B visa approvals and over 100,000 permanent labour certifications," Sonderling said.

That's hundreds of thousands of jobs that were taken from American workers, Sonderling said.

Indian professionals account for over 70 per cent of all approved H-1B petitions annually. The Vice President referred to foreign workers hired on H1-B visas as "foreign indentured servants" and the companies using the programme as "visa mills".

Vance also announced an investigation into the J-1 visa programme for research scholars utilised by nine major universities, including Yale, Harvard, Stanford and Caltech.

"Something weird is going on at these universities. They're using these visas way too much. They're using them to undercut the wages of American grad students and American researchers," Vance said.

The J-1 programme allows foreign nationals to enter the US as exchange visitors for activities, including research, teaching, study and specialised professional work.

"This is a fundamental insult to the American worker and to the American way of life. We cannot allow visa programs that were designed to ensure that American corporations had access to the best and the brightest, to use them to undercut the wages of American workers," Vance said.

"I don't care how prestigious the university thinks it is. Break the law and screw the American people, and I will personally cuff you in the university square," Inspector General Anthony D'Esposito, Department of Labour, said.

"I don't care how large your endowment is, how powerful your alumni are, or how many politicians you have on speed dial. As Vice President Vance said, nobody is above the law. That's why we're establishing a visa fraud strike team, bringing together investigative expertise from across government," D'Esposito said.

KEY POINTS

- 'There has been no company in the United States, unfortunately, that has abused this system more than Microsoft,' Vance said
- Labour Secretary Keith Sonderling said the Department of Labour will not accept any new or process any pending permanent labour certification applications involving these firms
- 'Since 2009, just these companies alone have requested almost three million foreign workers'

AI Express, AI, Akasa Air hike fuel surcharges amid rising ATF costs

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 8



Air India and Air India Express on Thursday announced hiking fuel surcharges for domestic and international flights, while Akasa Air raised the surcharge for overseas flights due to soaring jet fuel costs.

The hike in fuel surcharges from October 9 will push airfares higher as airlines look at ways to partially offset the rising operational costs.

Air India and Air India Express, which previously revised fuel surcharges in April, have increased them by Rs 101 to Rs 301 for domestic flights. For international services, the hike ranges from $5 to $15.

Akasa Air has re-introduced the fuel surcharge for domestic services and increased it for international flights. The airline, which introduced the surcharges in March, later withdrew them for domestic flights.

In a statement on Thursday, Air India said Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) prices have witnessed significant volatility in recent months, driven largely by geopolitical developments and sustained pressure on global energy markets.

"The latest increase in fuel prices has further elevated operating costs for airlines, with fuel continuing to account for a substantial proportion of overall airline expenditure," the statement said.

For domestic flights, Air India and Air India Express have revised fuel surcharges ranging from Rs 400 to Rs 1,200, depending on the distance.

Fuel surcharges for international flights vary from $55 to $215, depending on the region and country.

According to the statement, the two airlines will levy Rs 400 and Rs 600 as fuel surcharges for distances of 0-500 kilometre and 501-1,000 km, respectively. The amount will be Rs 850 for 1,001-1,500 km and Rs 1,200 for 1,501 km and above.

With respect to international routes, the fuel surcharge will be $55 for West Asia/ Middle East and $135 for Europe, including the UK. The fuel surcharge will be $210 for Australia and $215 for North America.

Akasa Airsaid in a statement that sustained increases in Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) prices, driven by ongoing geopolitical developments in the Middle East, have led to higher fuel surcharges.

Depending on distance, the surcharges will vary from Rs 375 to Rs 1,150 for domestic flights and in the case of overseas services, the revised surcharge is Rs 2,500.

For 0-500 km, Akasa Air will levy a fuel surcharge of Rs 375 and Rs 600 for the distance of 501 - 1,000 km. The fuel surcharge will be Rs 900 and Rs 1,150 for the distance of 1,001-1,500 km and 1,501 km and above, respectively.

For international routes, Akasa Air has revised the fuel surcharge to Rs 2,500.

In March, Akasa Air introduced fuel surcharges ranging from Rs 199 to Rs 1,300 for domestic and international flights.

"ATF constitutes a significant component of airline operating costs, and the continued increase in fuel prices has placed sustained pressure on airline operating costs across the industry."In view of the prevailing fuel price environment, Akasa Air has taken a measured approach to partially offset the impact," Akasa Air said.

Deposit rate hikes unlikely for three mnths, RBI action to help NIMs: SBI

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 8

SBI Chairman C S Setty on Thursday said he does not expect deposit rates to rise for the next two-three months due to excess liquidity in the banking system.

Setty said the RBI's shift towards tighter rates would help banks improve net interest margins (NIMs) for up to three quarters. "I believe that next two-three months, there may not be any rate action on the deposits because we have sufficient liquidity in the system," he told reporters.

He said banks may need to raise deposit rates if elevated credit growth continues & funding requirements increase, addeding that depositors should receive some positive real interest rate as inflation rises.

Setty said SBI can sustain loan growth of 14-15 per cent, noting that credit growth should ideally be 2-3 per cent above nominal GDP growth. With nominal GDP at 12 per cent, he said, 14-15 per cent credit growth would sustain economic momentum. Setty, who also chairs the Indian Banks Association, dismissed concerns of imprudent lending following nearly $133 billion in diaspora deposits.

He said FCNR(B)-related liquidity would be consumed over the next 2-3 quarters, while RBI liquidity absorption measures & credit demand would prevent lending exuberance.

He said RBI rate hikes could support NIMs for 2-3 quarters, while over 50 per cent of bank loans are linked to external benchmarks.

GQG sells 2.91% stake in ITC for ₹9,395 crore

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 8

GQG Partners sold a 2.91 per cent stake in FMCG major ITC for Rs 9,395 crore through separate block deals on Thursday, as the US-based boutique investment firm keeps paring down its holdings in Indian firms.

GQG Partners, through its fund, offloaded 36,50,84,221 shares in 14 tranches, representing a 2.91 per cent stake in Kolkata-based ITC, as per data on the BSE.

The shares were disposed of at an average price of Rs 257.35 apiece, taking the deal value to Rs 9,395.44 crore. In addition, Alliance Witan, one of the UK's oldest and largest investment trusts, sold another 16.11 lakh shares of ITC for Rs 41.46 crore.

At the June quarter end, GQG, through its fund, held a 1.06 per cent stake in ITC, while Goldman Sachs Trust II - Goldman Sachs GQG Partners International Opportunities Fund owned a 2.06 per cent holding in the company, as per shareholding data on the BSE.

GQG Partners on behalf of Goldman Sachs Asset Management, manages Goldman Sachs GQG Partners International Opportunities Fund.

Meanwhile, a clutch of domestic and foreign institutional investors acquired an equal number of shares at the same price.

US-based Fidelity International, through its arm, emerged as the largest buyer, picking up a total of 13.4 crore shares, amounting to nearly a 1.07 per cent stake in ITC for Rs 3,448.49 crore.

Mutual Funds managed by SBI, Kotak Mahindra, Mirae Asset, Aditya Birla Sun Life, Nippon India, ICICI Prudential and Edelweiss, along with ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company and Bajaj Life, also participated in the transaction.

Other foreign buyers included US-based Ghisallo Capital Management, BNP Paribas, Citigroup Global Markets Singapore, and Morgan Stanley.

Shares of ITC fell more than 4 per cent to close at Rs 254.05 apiece on the BSE. The ITC sale adds to a string of stake sales by GQG this year. During the June quarter, it sold more than Rs 12,000 crore worth of holdings across Adani Group companies.

Gold, silver imports by nominated agencies, banks to attract 3% IGST

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 8

Gold, silver & platinum imports by banks and nominated agencies attract 3 per cent IGST effective April 1, 2026, Revenue Secretary Arvind Shrivastava said on Thursday.

The Government notified the GST Council on Thursday that the list of designated banks and agencies that attract IGST exemptions on gold and precious metal imports has not been extended beyond March 31, 2026, Shrivastava said. This is done to ensure parity of taxes imposed on gold and other precious metal imports through other routes, including bullion.

Gold, silver & platinum imports attract a 3 per cent IGST, but before April 1, 2026, the tax was exempt when the precious metals were imported by banks & nominated agencies - a list of which is notified by the Government periodically.

That list was not notified on April 1 this year as gold, silver and precious metal imports, which led to forex outgo, became a concern for the Government. India is the world's second-biggest gold consumer after China and gold imports are driven by the jewellery industry demand.

Bagchi set to earn ₹43 cr on joining HDFC Bank, to be highest-paid banker

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 8

Anup Bagchi is set to earn Rs 43 crore in his first year as chief executive and managing director of HDFC Bank, making him the highest-paid banker.

Exchange filings showed Bagchi will receive Rs 8.97 crore in fixed compensation and Rs 26.92 crore in variable pay. He will get a one-time joining bonus of over Rs 7.3 crore, comprising restricted stock units worth Rs 3.19 crore and ESOPs worth Rs 4.16 crore, vesting over four years. The RBI cleared his remuneration while approving his appointment. Bagchi, currently an additional director, will take charge on October 27 after Sashidhar Jagdishan's term ends.

His annual compensation of Rs 35.90 crore exceeds Rs 17.23 crore received by Kotak Mahindra Bank CEO Ashok Vaswani and Rs 10.30 crore by Axis Bank CEO Amitabh Chaudhry in FY26. His variable pay includes Rs 8.88 crore in cash and Rs 18.04 crore through ESOPs.

JP Morgan bullish on small & mid-cap stocks

The brokerage has placed I-T sector in the 'underweight' category

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 8

Brokerage JP Morgan on Thursday said that it is more bullish on the Indian small- & mid-cap space compared to the large-cap segment & placed the information technology sector in the "underweight" category.

It said high-growth themes, including capex, modern manufacturing and artificial intelligence or data centres, are concentrated in the small- and mid-cap space rather than the large-cap space.

"We expect small- and mid-caps to continue outpacing large-caps in earnings growth, as the most compelling high-growth themes - capex, modern manufacturing, and AI/ data-center - are concentrated in these segments," it said. The brokerage said it is overweight on sectors, including financials, consumer discretionary, industrials, healthcare and materials & underweight on the IT.

For the Nifty-50 companies -- almost all of them being large caps, the brokerage expects a median revenue growth of 14 per cent and a post-tax profit of 15 per cent for the numbers to be reported for the September quarter.

A slew of factors, including a 15 per cent growth in GST collections, manufacturing PMI averaging higher and non-food bank credit growth at an average of 19.2 per cent, point to strength in economic activity in the September quarter.

The key events to watch include developments in the US-Iran ceasefire, the IPO pipeline and primary market supply, progress on the India-US trade deal and the tariff trajectory, which will include how the threats of Russia-linked 100 per cent duties play out, and also the implementation of the deals with the EU and the UK, it said. RBI's rate hikes, liquidity conditions, food inflation and the pace and spatial spread of the South West monsoon also need to be monitored, it added.

CLOSER LOOK

- The brokerage has placed financials, consumer discretionary, industrials, healthcare & materials in the 'overweight' category
- For the Nifty-50 companies — almost all of them being large caps, the brokerage expects a median revenue growth of 14%

Rajputana Royals beat Prithviraaj Yodhas in APL season 2 opener

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Hyderabad, October 8

Defending champions Rajputana Royals beat Prithviraaj Yodhas 5-3 in the opening match of the second edition of Archery Premier League here on Wednesday.

With compound archers Ojas Deotale and world No 1 Ella Gibson leading the way with high-scoring arrows at the start, Royals also had Tokyo Olympic recurve champion Mete Gazoz to thank, as he repeatedly closed out the sets with the 120-second countdown winding down.

THE ROYALS WON THE FIRST SET ROYALS 73-69 AS GRANDE'S 7 WITH HIS FIRST ARROW PUT YODHAS ON THE BACKFOOT AND PLAYING CATCH-UP

The Abhishek Verma-led Yodhas bounced back from a slow start and could have taken the match into a hit-or-miss shootoff with the final arrow too, but Mexico's Mathias Grande shot a costly 8 in the end.

The world's first franchise-based archery league with 36 Indians and 12 elite international stars.

The league will culminate on October 18 with the grand finale featuring the top four teams in the semi-final followed by the title clash.

The Royals won the first set Royals 73-69 as Grande's 7 with his first arrow put Yodhas on the backfoot and playing catch-up. Deotale, who was the source of the Royals' high energy just as he was last season, set the tone for the Royals along with Gibson, while India's Ankita Bhakat played able support to Gazoz.

ZELJKOVIC GOAL SEALS 1-0 WIN OVER EAST BENGAL

Mohun Bagan claim 22nd IFA Shield title

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kolkata, October 8

Riding on Samir Zeljkovic's solitary strike, Mohun Bagan Super Giant retained the IFA Shield with a hard-fought 1-0 victory over arch-rivals East Bengal in a fiercely contested Kolkata Derby at the Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan here on Thursday.

Bosnian midfielder Zeljkovic scored the decisive goal in the 45th minute, converting shortly before the interval to give the Mariners their 22nd IFA Shield title.

This is the 22nd time that Mohun Bagan claimed the prestigious tournament and after nearly five decades that they have won the Calcutta Football League (CFL) and IFA Shield in same season.



Bosnian midfielder Zeljkovic scored the decisive goal in the 45th minute

Last time they achieved the feat, late PK Banerjee was the coach in the year 1976. It was far from a fluent performance from either side, but Mohun Bagan looked considerably more assured than they had in the Durand Cup final earlier this season, when East Bengal had inflicted a 4-1 defeat on their city rivals.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Last time they achieved the feat, late PK Banerjee was the coach in the year 1976
- Mohun Bagan looked considerably more assured than they had in the Durand Cup final earlier this season
- The goal gave Mohun Bagan a crucial advantage in a game that remained tightly contested after the break

Zeljkovic broke the deadlock on the stroke of half-time after controlling a chipped pass from Sahal Abdul Samad on his chest before calmly slotting the ball past the East Bengal goalkeeper.

The goal gave Mohun Bagan a crucial advantage in a game that remained tightly contested after the break, with East Bengal pushing for an equaliser but failing to find a way past the Mariners' defence.

2nd T20I: India eye lead against WI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Ranchi, October 8

Sanju Samson's lean run is the lone sore point in an otherwise firing batting line-up and it will prompt the team management to ponder over pairing teen sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi with opener Abhishek Sharma in the second T20I against the West Indies here on Friday.

A win here will power India to a 2-0 lead in the five-match series, but the hosts will certainly want a more productive outing from Samson.

The Kerala batter's last four innings read: 9, 7, 2, 11. Consequently, the partnerships involving Samson in the previous four matches stand at: 7, 12, 2 (both for 2nd wicket with Sooryavanshi coming in as opener), and 29.

But the middle-order led by skipper Shreyas Iyer, who has finally found his footing as T20I captain, has covered up those failures in spectacular fashion. Iyer also hammered his maiden T20I century in the 68th match of his career.

So, there will be a temptation to give Sooryavanshi another run. The left-hander has shown that T20 cricket comes naturally to him in the limited opportunities he has received so far. His wide and unique range of shots, coupled with the ability to produce match-winning knocks have made him a compelling package.

But India have so far backed the established opening combination of Abhishek and Samson.

The management's support of Samson was evident when he was accommodated at No.3 in the Asian Games in Japan, while giving the opening slot to Sooryavanshi.

However, Samson is yet to respond to that show of faith in him with matching performances.



Sanju Samson during a training session ahead of the second T20I match, in Ranchi PTI

Teams

INDIA: Shreyas Iyer (c), Tilak Varma, Abhishek Sharma, Arshdeep Singh, Shivam Dube, Ishan Kishan, Naman Dhir, Kuldeep Yadav, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Axar Patel, Prince Yadav, Ravi Bishnoi, Sanju Samson (wk), Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Mayank Yadav.

West Indies: Shai Hope (c and wk), Jewel Andrew, Roston Chase, Matthew Forde, Shimron Hetmyer, Akeal Hosein, Shamar Joseph, Gudakesh Motie, Keemo Paul, Kamil Pooran, Rovman Powell, Sherfane Rutherford, Quentin Sampson, Romario Shepherd, Shamar Springer.

MATCH STARTS AT 7PM.

India turn focus to ACT after Asian Games triumph

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mohali, October 8

Fresh from retaining its men's Asian Games hockey title and securing a direct berth for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, India will now turn its attention to the Asian Champions Trophy, to be held in Jalandhar and Mohali from October 27 to November 5.

The six-team tournament will feature India alongside Japan, China, Malaysia, South Korea and Bangladesh.

India recently defeated Malaysia in the Asian Games final in Aichi-Nagoya to successfully defend the gold medal they won in Hangzhou in 2023.

It was the first time India had retained the Asian Games hockey title.

Head coach Craig Fulton, however, believes the Asian Games triumph is now behind the team and the focus must shift to the next challenge, with India keen to carry the same intensity into the home tournament.

India go down 0-4 to Russia in Kolkata friendly

Russia's sustained pressure wore down the Blue Tigresses after break

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kolkata, October 8

A new-look Indian women's national team held their own for much of the first half before conceding a 0-4 defeat to Russia in the first of two international friendlies at a rain-soaked Kishore Bharati Krirangan on Thursday.

Iana Sheina's moment of brilliance gave the visitors the lead in the 40th minute, and substitute Kira Petukhova struck twice in the 60th and 65th minutes. Iana Svistunova completed the scoring in the 81st minute as Russia's sustained pressure wore down the Blue Tigresses after the break.

Head coach Crispin Chettri used the occasion to test his emerging players, handing international debuts to Babysana Devi Thingbaijam, Malati Munda, Cindy Colney, Shubhangi Singh, Dhurga Perumal and Sibani Devi Nongmeikapam. Goalkeeper Monalisha Devi Moirangthem made her first start and earned her third cap overall.

The 69th-ranked Blue Tigresses faced a considerable challenge against 27th-ranked Russia in what was India's first-ever women's international match in Kolkata. Yet, for much of the opening half, the hosts defended with discipline and created opportunities that could have changed the course of the contest.

Russia enjoyed more possession and territorial control, pushing players forward to stretch India's defensive shape. The Blue Tigresses responded with a compact block, tracking runners and closing passing lanes, while Monalisha stood firm behind them.

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

RUN OF MORE FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

In order to clear extra rush of passengers during this Festival Season, Railways have decided to run the following additional Festival Special Trains as per details given below:

04064/04063 Delhi Jn.-Gaya Jn.-Delhi Jn. Reserved Festival Spl. Exp. (6 Days in a week) — 88 Trips

Train No. 04064 ARR.	Train No. 04064 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 04063 ARR.	Train No. 04063 DEP.
---	11:00	Delhi Jn.	08:00	---
07:15	---	Gaya Jn.	---	09:15

Days of run : 04064 Ex. Delhi Jn. from 11.10.2026 to 30.11.2026 (Except Saturday) and **04063 Ex. Gaya Jn.** from 12.10.2026 to 01.12.2026 (Except Sunday)
Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: New Delhi, Tundla Jn., Govindpuri, Subedarganj, Pt. Deendayal Upadhyaya Jn., Bhabua Road, Sasaram, Dehri-on-Son & Anugrah Narayan Road Stations.

04088/04087 New Delhi-Patna Jn.-New Delhi Reserved Festival Special Express (Daily) — 104 Trips

Train No. 04088 ARR.	Train No. 04088 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 04087 ARR.	Train No. 04087 DEP.
---	15:50	New Delhi	13:30	---
12:45	---	Patna Jn.	---	15:10

Days of run : 04088 Ex. New Delhi from 10.10.2026 to 30.11.2026 (Daily) and **04087 Ex. Patna Jn.** from 11.10.2026 to 01.12.2026 (Daily)
Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Tundla Jn., Govindpuri, Prayagraj Jn., Pt. Deendayal Upadhyaya Jn., Dildarnagar Jn., Buxar, Raghunathpur & Ara Jn. Stations.

01483/01484 Khadki-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Khadki Superfast Special (Bi-Weekly) — 26 Trips

Train No. 01483 ARR.	Train No. 01483 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 01484 ARR.	Train No. 01484 DEP.
---	17:30	Khadki	22:15	---
18:10	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	---	22:10

Days of run : 01483 Ex. Khadki from 09.10.2026 to 20.11.2026 (on every Tuesday, Friday) and **01484 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin** from 10.10.2026 to 21.11.2026 (on every Wednesday, Saturday)
Composition: 2 Tier AC & 3 Tier AC
Stoppages: Lonavala, Kalyan Jn., Bhiwandi Road, Vasai Road, Palghar, Vapi, Valsad, Surat, Vadodara Jn., Ratlam Jn., Bhawani Mandi, Kota Jn., Sawai Madhopur & Mathura Jn. Stations.

04221/04222 Varanasi Jn.-Bathinda Jn.-Varanasi Jn. Reserved Special Express (Weekly) — 14 Trips

Train No. 04221 ARR.	Train No. 04221 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 04222 ARR.	Train No. 04222 DEP.
---	20:40	Varanasi Jn.	17:30	---
17:00	---	Bhatinda Jn.	---	20:50

Days of run : 04221 Ex. Varanasi Jn. from 11.10.2026 to 22.11.2026 (on every Sunday) and **04222 Ex. Bathinda Jn.** from 12.10.2026 to 23.11.2026 (on every Monday)
Composition: 3 Tier AC Economy & General
Stoppages: Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratapgarh Jn., Rae Bareli Jn., Utraitia Jn., Alam Nagar, Bareilly Jn., Moradabad Jn., Najibabad Jn., Saharanpur Jn., YamunanagarJagadhri, Ambala Cantt., Rajpura Jn., Patiala, Dhuri Jn., Barnala & Rampura Phul Stations.

04634/04633 Firozpur Cantt.-Purnea Jn.-Firozpur Cantt. Reserved Spl. Exp. (Weekly) — 15 Trips

Train No. 04634 ARR.	Train No. 04634 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 04633 ARR.	Train No. 04633 DEP.
---	17:30	Firozpur Cantt.	16:35	---
03:00	---	Purnea Jn.	---	06:00

Days of run : 04634 Ex. Firozpur Cantt. from 15.10.2026 to 26.11.2026 (on every Thursday) and **04633 Ex. Purnea Jn.** from 10.10.2026 to 28.11.2026 (on every Saturday)
Composition: 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General
Stoppages: Makhu, Lohian Khas Jn., Nakodar Jn., Phillaur Jn., Dhandari Kalan, Chandigarh, Ambala Cantt., Yamunanagar Jagadhri, Saharanpur Jn., Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjehanpur, Sitapur Jn., Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur, Chhapra, Sonpur, Hajipur Jn., Shahpur Patoree, Barauni Jn., Begusarai, Khagaria Jn., Mansi Jn., Naugachia & Katihar Jn. Stations.

07651/07652 Jalna-Chhapra Jn.-Jalna Special Express (Weekly) — 07 Trips

Train No. 07651 ARR.	Train No. 07651 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 07652 ARR.	Train No. 07652 DEP.
---	23:35	Jalna	09:50	---
03:15	03:25	Varanasi Jn.	03:10	03:15
09:35	---	Chhapra Jn.	---	21:00

Days of run : 07651 Ex. Jalna from 14.10.2026 to 28.10.2026 (on Every Wednesday) and **07652 Ex. Chhapra Jn.** from 09.10.2026 to 30.10.2026 (on Every Friday)
Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, Nagarsol, Manmad Jn., Bhusaval Jn., Khandwa Jn.,Harda, Itarsi Jn., Pipariya, Gadarwara, Narsinghpur, Jabalpur, Katni Jn., Maihar, Satna Jn., Manikpur Jn., Prayagraj Chheoki, Jaunpur Jn., Aunrihar Jn., Ghazipur City & Ballia Stations.

07621/07622 Nanded-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Nanded Special Express (Weekly) — 14 Trips

Train No. 07621 ARR.	Train No. 07621 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 07622 ARR.	Train No. 07622 DEP.
---	08:45	Nanded	00:35	---
14:00	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	---	21:40

Days of run : 07621 Ex. Nanded from 17.10.2026 to 28.11.2026 (on Every Saturday) and **07622 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn.** from 18.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 (on Every Sunday)
Composition: 1st AC, 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Purna Jn., Parbhani Jn., Selu, Partur, Jalna, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, Manmad Jn., Jalgaon Jn., Bhusawal Jn., Khandwa Jn., Itarsi Jn., Bhopal Jn., Bina Jn., Virangana Lakshmibai Jhansi Jn., Gwalior Jn., Agra Cantt. & Mathura Jn. Station.

07021/07022 Charlapalli-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Charlapalli Special Express (Weekly) — 14 Trips

Train No. 07021 ARR.	Train No. 07021 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 07022 ARR.	Train No. 07022 DEP.
---	19:20	Charlapalli	13:50	---
02:00	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	---	04:00

Days of run : 07021 Ex. Charlapalli from 19.10.2026 to 30.11.2026 (on Every Monday) and **07022 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin** from 21.10.2026 to 02.12.2026 (on Every Wednesday)
Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Kazipet Jn., Ramgundam, Manchiryal, Bellampalli, Sirpur Kaghaznagar, Balharshah, Nagpur Jn., Itarsi Jn., Bhopal Jn., Bina Jn., Virangana Lakshmibai Jhansi Jn., Gwalior Jn., Dhaulpur, Agra Cantt., Mathura Jn., & Kosi Kalan Stations.

07023/07024 Charlapalli-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Charlapalli Special Express (Weekly) — 12 Trips

Train No. 07023 ARR.	Train No. 07023 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 07024 ARR.	Train No. 07024 DEP.
---	19:45	Charlapalli	17:45	---
05:00	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	---	07:15

Days of run : 07023 Ex. Charlapalli from 20.10.2026 to 24.11.2026 (on Every Tuesday) and **07024 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin** from 22.10.2026 to 26.11.2026 (on Every Thursday)
Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Kazipet Jn., Ramgundam, Manchiryal, Bellampalli, Sirpur Kaghaznagar, Balharshah, Nagpur Jn., Itarsi Jn., Bhopal Jn., Bina Jn., Virangana Lakshmibai Jhansi Jn., Gwalior Jn. & Agra Cantt. Stations.

04083/04084 New Delhi-Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra-New Delhi Reserved Spl. (Weekly) — 04 Trips

Train No. 04083 ARR.	Train No. 04083 DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 04084 ARR.	Train No. 04084 DEP.
---	14:00	New Delhi	23:30	---
03:00	---	Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra	---	10:00

Days of run : 04083 Ex. New Delhi on 09.10.2026 & 16.10.2026 (Friday) and **04084 Ex. Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra** on 10.10.2026 & 17.10.2026 (Saturday)
Composition: 1st AC, 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.
Stoppages: Sonipat, Panipat Jn., Kurukshetra Jn., Ambala Cantt., Dhandari Kalan, Jalandhar Cantt., Pathankot Cantt., Martyr Captain Sunil Kr. Choudhary Kathua, Jammu Tawi & Martyr Captain Tushar Mahajan Stations

Revision in Frequency and Extension in Periodicity of Train No. 04090/04089 New Delhi-Danapur-New Delhi via Delhi Jn. Reserved Festival Special Superfast

Train No. & Name	Existing Frequency & Day of run	Revised frequency & day of run	Date w.e.f.
04090 New Delhi-Danapur Special	Friday (Weekly)	**Friday, Wednesday (Bi-Weekly)**	07.10.2026
04089 Danapur-New Delhi Special	Saturday (Weekly)	**Saturday, Thursday (Bi-Weekly)**	07.10.2026

	Existing Dates	Extension Upto	Additional Trips	No. of Additional Trips
Ex. New Delhi	20.11.2026	27.11.2026	14, 21, 28.10.2026 & 04, 11, 18, 25, 27.11.2026	08 Trips
Ex. Danapur	21.11.2026	28.11.2026	15, 22, 29.10.2026 & 05, 12, 19, 26, 28.11.2026	08 Trips

NOTE: REST INFORMATION WILL HOLD GOOD.

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

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SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Sindhu advances in Arctic Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Vantaa, October 8

Two-time Olympic medallist P V Sindhu saw off Japan's Riko Gunji to advance to the quarterfinals of women's singles but it was curtains for the Indian men's singles players at the USD 500,000 Arctic Open Super 500 tournament here on Thursday.

Sindhu, the 31-year-old from Hyderabad, who won the Japan Open Super 750 title in July, notched up a 21-15 21-15 win over Gunji in the second round.

The sixth seeded Indian will face top seed and former world champion Ratchanok Inthanon from Thailand.

However, it was a disappointing outing for Tharun Mannepalli and Tanvi Sharma, who suffered straight-game defeats.

Second seed Christo Popov of France beat Mannepalli 21-14, 21-19, while Ratchanok defeated Tanvi 21-18, 21-7 in lop-sided contests.

Kidambi Srikanth, a former world No. 1, also bowed out in the opening round after losing 21-15, 15-21, 13-21 to Canada's Brian Yang.

Later in the day, men's doubles pair of Krishna Prasad Garaga and Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy will face England's Oliver Butler and Samuel Jones.

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.

OFFICE OF THE GENERAL MANAGER (O&M) CIRCLE, SHIVPURI
E-mail : gmshivpuri2022@gmail.com

No. GM/O&M/SPR/PUR/5747 — Shivpuri, Dated : 08.10.2026

TENDER NOTICE

MPMKVVCL Shivpuri hereby invites online tenders for the following work as per tender specification :-

Particulars	Appr. Value (In Crore)	Tender Fee (Inclusive of GST@18%) (In. Rs.)	Bid Submission Last Date & Time	Bid Opening Date & Time
Empanelment of Agencies for new 33/11kV substation, additional/ Augmentation of PTR at existing 33/11 KV S/s, HT Lines, LT Lines, DTR, Service Line and meter related works and any other associated works as per SOR schedules in Shivpuri Circle of MPMKVVCL	10.00 Cr.	10000/- + 18% GST = 11800/-	22.10.2026 Up to 15.00 Hrs.	23.10.2026 at 15.30 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : **https://portal.mpcz.in & https://mptenders.gov.in** or the under signed office.

M.P. Madhyam/128462/2026 — **GENERAL MANAGER (O&M) SHIVPURI**

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

SALEM DIVISION
Office of the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer,
Electric Loco Shed, Erode
E-TENDER NOTICE

Online tenders is invited for the following work :

Tender No.	**SA_A_RS_ED_OT_26_27_15, Dated : 05.10.2026**
Description of work	**Works contract for Reconditioning of Smoothing Reactor (SL-30) of electric locomotives available at Electric Loco Shed, Southern Railway, Salem Division, Erode.**

All details regarding the tender are available at **https://www.ireps.gov.in**

DEE/RS/ED
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer, Rolling Stock, Erode.

NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Re-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1	04/GM(Civil)/ SM(E/M-III)/ 2026-27	Comprehensive Annual Maintenance For EPABX Telephone System installed & CCTV at Command Control Centre Building Near Mahamaya Flyover Sector-94 Noida	15.20
2	10/GM(Civil)/ SM(E/M-III)/ 2026-27	Shifting of CCTV Camera Pole and cables for proposed underpass on Noida to Greater Noida Express way, Noida	9.90
3	26/GM/SM (NTC)/ 2025-26	P/L Thermoplastic Paint and road Safety work on road between Sector-55 and 56, Noida.	7.30

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated **09.10.2026** to **15.10.2026** up to **5.00 PM.** Pre-qualification shall be opened / downloaded on dated **16.10.2026** at **11.00 AM.**

General Manager (Civil)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

झारखण्ड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता, का कार्यालय,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पाकुड़

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई– निविदा सूचना संख्या – **RDD/SD/PAKUR/06/2026-27**

01. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :

ग्रुप सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
01	पाकुड़ जिला के प्रखण्ड पाकुड़िया पंचायत खजूरडंगाल ग्राम सागबेरिया और गांगमुण्डी के बीच पगला नदी पर पुल निर्माण	30073100.00	601500.00	10,000.00	18 (Eighteen Month)
02	पाकुड़ जिला के प्रखण्ड पाकुड़िया पंचायत लागडुम ग्राम लागडुम चिरुडीह सुदा टोला से छोटा बरमसिया आर0ई0ओ0 पथ के बीच पुलिया निर्माण	26662100.00	533300.00	10,000.00	18 (Eighteen Month)
03	पाकुड़ जिला के प्रखण्ड महेशपुर गायबथान ग्राम गायबथान दुकानटोला से बरमसिया के बीच नाला पर पुल निर्माण।	21548100.00	431000.00	10,000.00	15 (Fifteen Month)

02. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 12.10.2026
03. ऑनलाईन परिमाण विपत्र क्रय करने की तिथि एवं समय–दिनांक–12.10.2026 से दिनांक–22.10.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
04. निविदा में संशोधन / वापसी की अंतिम तिथि–17.11.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
05. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 23.10.2026 से दिनांक 13.11.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
06. ई–निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, पाकुड।
07. ई–निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय –19.11.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे।
08. ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पाकुड।
09. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9955549665 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)।
10. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है तद्नुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।
11. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
12. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई–भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पाकुड़

PR 391347 Rural Work Department(26-27)#D

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, HAZARIBAG.

e-Procurement Tender Notice Two Envelope System
Tender Reference No. :- DMFT/MID/ HAZARIBAG/F2-40/2025-26 (2nd Call)
Letter no - 1073 — **Date :- 08.10.2026**

1.	Name of the work	Construction of P.C.C road from Basariya P.W.D road of Panchayat - Basariya via Gudiya Pond to Amjhar kalikaran road, Village- Basariya, Panchayat- Basariya, Block- Chouparan, District- Hazaribag
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	**Rs.- 1,29,65,500.00**
3.	Time of Completion	11 Months
4.	Date of Publication of e-Tender on website	12.10.2026 at 1:00 P.M **(e-Procurement Portal- http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)**
5.	Last date/Time for Submission of e-Tender bids Online	28.10.2026 up to 5:00 P.M
6.	Last Date for Online Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	28.10.2026 up to 5:00 P.M
7.	Date of opening of e-Tender	30.10.2026 at 03:00 P.M
8.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Hazaribag
9.	Contact no. of e-Procurement officer	06546-270485
10.	E-mail of e- Procurement officer	eemidhbg-cemr-jhr@nic.in

Note:- 1.) Only e-Tender will be accepted.
2.) Published Estimated Cost may be increased or decreased.
3.) Further details can be seen and Mode of Submission of Online Tender/Tender Fee/EMD through http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

PR 391390 — **Executive Engineer,**
(Minor Irrigation)26-27*D — **Minor Irrigation Division,Hazaribag.**

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	**Name of Work with its location :** Augmentation/Replacement of Catenary wire over Delhi Division (7th Phase).
2	**Approx. Cost of work :** Rs. 1,80,29,018.38/-
3	**Earnest Money Deposit :** Rs. 3,60,600/-
4	**E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period :** 19.10.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 02.11.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5	**E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time :** 02.11.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6	**Fund Allocation :** Capital (PH-36)
7	**Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in**

No.: 09E-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 07.10.2026 — 3494/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-Oct-01 — **Dated: 07.10.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway, Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites **"Open Tender"** through on Line only (**E-Tendering**) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

SN: 1 | **Tender No.:** 2026-Oct-01-01 | **Approx Cost Rs.:** 61727648.00

Description of work: A. Complete track renewal (P) of 12.994 Kms with Contractors PQRS portal in IDH-BXN Section under ADEN-Line/Agra section. **B.** AGC-DHO Through sleeper renewal (P) of 24.172 Kms with Contractors PQRS portal in AGC-DHO Section under ADEN/DHO section.

SN: 2 | **Tender No.:** 2026-Oct-01-02 | **Approx Cost Rs.:** 31865465.49

Description of work: A. TRR (P) 40.00 TKm in Fatehabad - Manikpura section. **B.** TRR (P) 20.800 TKm in Bah - Udimore section. **C.** Provision of Track machine siding at FAB, HAB & UDMR stations.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **"www.ireps.gov.in".** Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **15.00 hrs.** on **28.10.2026** — 2292/26(K)

North central railways — www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in — @CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-GSU-2026-11	**Earnest Money:** ₹ 213300.00
Description of work:-Trackwork: Provision of additional goods line with increasement in existing goods wharf at New Lalitpur town station of Jhansi Division N.C.Railway	
Approx Cost: ₹ 10662379.73	**Date of closing Tender:** 06.11.2026
Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 month	

- Tender online can be submitted up to **10:30 hrs** on **06.11.2026.**
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.** — 2287/26(AK)

North central railways — @CPRONCR — www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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जिला परिषद् कार्यालय, जामताड़ा

Email Id: zilaparishad_jamtara@yahoo.com

निविदा रद्दीकरण सूचना

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के अल्पकालीन ई0–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–ZILA/PARISHAD/JAMTARA/08/ 2026-27, PR-389916 Rural Development (26-27)D को अपरिहार्य कारणवश रद्द किया जाता है।

ह0/–
जिला अभियंता
जिला परिषद्, जामताड़ा।

PR 391314 Rural Development(26-27)D

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

No. ECR/CAO/Con/WT/Tender/North/ 18-26-27 dated : 06.10.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE NO. - ECR-CAO-C-N-18-26-27 E-TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDER MENTIONED WORK.
S.N. : 1. Name of work with it's location : Leftover miscellaneous work like construction of minor bridges, earth work in filling on embankment, blanketing, retaining wall, boulder backing & turffing on slope of embankment between Madhubani to Sagauli section in connection with construction of Hajipur-Sagauli New Rail line project. **2. Approx. cost of the work of :** Rs. 95,91,30,046.19, **3. Bid Security Amount :** Rs. 1,91,82,600.00, **4. Date and time for closing of tender :** 03.11.2026 at 14:30 hrs., **5. Website particulars, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and addressed of the office from where the tender form be purchased etc. :** The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. **http://www.ireps.gov.in. Note:** In case of any descripencies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website **http://www.ireps.gov.in** atleast 15 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.

CAO/Con/North
E. C. Railway, MHX, Patna
PR/1076/CN/N/MHX/CONST/T/26-27/40

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division), Jhajjar
Bimla
Vs.
Jugti Ram
CNR No. HRJR02-001657-2018
Next Date:- 13-11-2026

That pass a decree in favour of the plaintiff and against the defendants
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO :
Jugti Ram Through LRS 1(a) Jagwanti d/o Jugti Ram (b) Kamlesh d/o Jugti Ram (c) Dhanpati d/o Jugti Ram (d) Anita d/o Jugti Ram and Maan Singh Through Lrs 2(a) Samander Singh S/o Maan Singh (b) Krishan kumar S/o Maan Singh All village Kheri Hoshdarpur Tehsil and Distt Jhajjar

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **13-11-2026** at **10:00.a.m.** For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs = district Notice&district=Jhajjar**

Sd/-Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
date 06.10.2026 — **Jhajjar**

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

Hue And Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

Police Station Hiranagarvide letter no. 985/5-1/PSH dated 25-09-2026 has intimated that the accused namely Roshan Din @ Raja S/O Liaqat Ali R/O Rakh Sarkar Plai Tehsil Hiranagar and District Kathua, is evading his arrest in Case FIR No. 099/2026 U/S 303(2)/132/109/191(2) BNS, 3/25 Arms Act, 26/33 Forest Actof Police Station Hiranagarsince the commission of crime.

During the investigation of said case, best efforts are made by concerned I/O to locate/arrest said accused person which has yielded no result and accused person is still at large.

As such, description roll/photograph of wanted accused is being circulated with the appeal that anybody having information about his whereabouts may inform us on below given Phone Numbers/E-mail ID. The identity of the informer will be kept secret and he will also be rewarded suitably. Anybody found providing shelter to the accused person or concealing his presence will also be booked.

Description Roll:-



•Name	Roshan Din @ Raja
•Father	Liaqat Ali
•Address	Rakh Sarkar Plai
•Tehsil	Hiranagar
•District	Kathua
• Police Station	Hiranagar

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. SDPO Border – 9186316009
5. SHO P/S Hiranaga 9186316019

Sd/- Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua

DIP No:DIP/J-12020/26

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millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

My name is Bandna Devi but in my Aadhar Card it is wrongly mentioned as Bandana Devi which is wrong. Both names are of the same person. From today i will be known as Bandna Devi w/o Digvijay Singh R/o Village and Post Ramwa Panthuva Tehsil Fatehpur U . P .

HIMACHAL PRADESH
JAL SHAKTI VIBHAG
"SHORT TERMS NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER"

The Executive Engineer Jal Shakti Division Pooh, Distt. Kinnaur Invites item rate tender on behalf of the Governor of H.P. from the eligible contractors for the following works through e-tendering process.

Sr. No	Name of work	Estimated cost Rs	Earnest Money Rs	Cost of tender form Rs	Time limit.
1	NAME OF WORK: - Providing Sewerage System to Ribba Village in Tehsil MoorangDistt.Kinnaur(HP) (SH: -Construction of 0.430 MLD Sewage Treatment Plant based on Biodigester, Rootzone Technology including O&M for three years.	45063102	525631	7000	1 year

Date of online publication of e-tendering06-10-2026and Last date of submissionof e-tendering 14-10-2026upto 05:00PM and shall be opened on 15-10-2026at 11.00AM.Tender document and other detailed can be downloaded or viewed online from at **http://hptenders.gov.in** by the firm/individual registered on the website free of cost.

Executive Engineer
Jal Shakti Division Pooh
Ph 01785-232254

Ro.No 3982/2026-2027

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-AUCTION NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS **(http:ireps.gov.in/)** for the allotment of Deluxe Pay & Use Toilet Contracts on MOT Basis, at following Railway stations/locations:-

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
PaynUse-11-2026	23.10.2026 at 12:00 Hrs.	Hazrat Nizamuddin (NZM) 02 Sites, Delhi (DLI) 01 Site, Anand Vihar (ANVT) 01 Site, SONIPAT (SNP) 01 Site, Modinagar (MDNR) 01 Site, Narwana (NRW) 01 Site, Mansa (MSZ) 01 Site, Delhi Sarai Rohilla (DEE) 01 site, Subzi Mandi (SZM) 01 Site & Panipat (PNP) 01 Site Total 11 Sites.
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen		**https://ireps.gov.in/**

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module
- Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module
- Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details
- A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender/ E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi -110055. Email: sanitationcell@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084

No.: 7PUB/TN/Pay&UseToilets/Auction/2022 Date: 07.10.2026 — **3491/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Executive Engineer
P. W. Division No.1, Nagpur
e-mail div1nagpur.ee@mahapwd.com

Corrigendum

Ref :- E-Tender Notice No 41 /RAC/ 2026-27

SR.No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In lakh)	Cost of Blank Tender Form	Time limit in Tender (Calendar Months)
	Open Tender			
1	Repairs and renovation to Type-II Quarters building no. 3 at new colony Ravi Nagar, Nagpur	105.04	1180/-	01 Months
2	Repairs and renovation to Type-II Quarters building no. 4 at new colony Ravi Nagar, Nagpur	105.04	1180/-	01 Months

Executive Engineer, Public Works Division No.1, Nagpur had invited above reference tenders Which was published by this office outward no.8805 dated 30.09.2026 in Tender Notice No 41 on Sr.No. 5 and 6. **Kindly note that above mentioned Tenders are cancelled due to Technical reason.**

O.W. No. dt.

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION NO.1,
Nagpur

Dgipr/2026-27/3161

Government of Maharashtra
Public Works Department P.W. Division, Panvel
Telephone No. 022-27452778
E- Tender Notice No. 08 (Open ONLINE) Year-2026-27
E-mail address:- panvel.ee@mahapwd.gov.in Fax Number :-022-27467440

Executive Engineer P.W. Division Panvel invite B-1 Tender From Registered Contractor with Govt. of Maharashtra Detail Tender Notice Available On **www.mahapwd.gov.in and www.mahatenders.gov.in Portal.**

Note:-Total 4 Work include in Tender notice.

Online Tender Download & Bid Preparation Period Date 09.10.2026 At 10.00 AM To Date 16.10.2026 18.00 PM.

Online Tender Bid Preparation Last Date 16.10.2026 at 18.00 AM.

E-Tender/O.No./P.W./PNL/
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Public work Division, Panvel.
Dist. Raigad
Date -

Executive Engineer
P.W.Division
Panvel

Dgipr/2026-27/3152

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

Hue And Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

Police Station Hiranagarvide letter no. 984/5-1/PSH dated 25-09-2026 has intimated that the accused namely Shoket Ali @ Anki S/O Kaju Din R/O Battal Chack Tehsil Hiranagar and District Kathua, is evading his arrest in Case FIR No. 099/2026 U/S 303(2)/132/109/191(2) BNS, 3/25 Arms Act, 26/33 Forest Actof Police Station Hiranagarsince the commission of crime.

During the investigation of said case, best efforts are made by concerned I/O to locate/arrest said accused person which has yielded no result and accused person is still at large.

As such, description roll/photograph of wanted accused is being circulated with the appeal that anybody having information about his whereabouts may inform us on below given Phone Numbers/E-mail ID. The identity of the informer will be kept secret and he will also be rewarded suitably. Anybody found providing shelter to the accused person or concealing his presence will also be booked.

Description Roll:-



•Name	Shoket Ali @ Anki
•Father	Kaju Din
•Address	Battal Chack
•Tehsil	Hiranagar
•District	Kathua
• Police Station	Hiranagar

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. SDPO Border – 9186316009
5. SHO P/S Hiranaga 9186316019

Sd/- Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua

DIP No:DIP/J-12015/26

1951 - 2026



HE COULD BE TERRIFYING IN ONE FILM AND HILARIOUS IN ANOTHER. HE COULD DOMINATE A SCENE WITHOUT SAYING MUCH AND TURN A SIMPLE LINE INTO A MOMENT PEOPLE REMEMBERED FOR YEARS





Nana Patekar: MORE THAN AN ACTOR

From 'Krantiveer' to 'Natsamrat', Nana Patekar created memorable characters, while beyond cinema, he became a quiet champion of farmers



ANINDITA ACHARYA
Kolkata, October 8

At the 40th Filmfare Awards in 1995, Nana Patekar stood almost teary-eyed as he received the 'Best Actor' award from the legendary Dilip Kumar. "I know I don't look like an actor. Yet I have received this award today. I am happy that today I am one of you," said Nana. 31 years have passed since that evening and Nana went on to become one of the most versatile and powerful performers in Hindi and Marathi cinema. But perhaps what made him extraordinary was that he was never just an actor. He was never even a conventional screen hero. In fact, his real-life persona was almost the antithesis of the glamorous Hindi film star and perhaps that is what made his journey so remarkable. On Thursday, at the age of 75, the veteran actor passed away after suffering a cardiac arrest at his residence in Goa.

No, Nana didn't have the conventional looks of a Hindi film hero. He himself often spoke about how he looked more like a villain. But talent has never been decided by looks. What Nana brought to the screen was far more potent: an unmistakable presence, a voice that could command a scene, an extraordinary ability to deliver dialogue and a versatility that made it impossible to put him in a box. In a career spanning more than four decades, he carved out his own space almost from the beginning. He made his big-screen debut with the 1978 drama 'Gaman'. Then came Mira Nair's 'Salaam Bombay!', where he showed that there was something distinctly powerful about his presence. But it was Vidhu Vinod Chopra's 'Parinda' in 1989 that announced his arrival in Hindi cinema in unmistakable terms.

As the dreaded gangster Anna, Nana created a character that was volatile and unforgettable. The film, loosely inspired by Marlon Brando's 'On the Waterfront', also starred Jackie Shroff, Anil Kapoor and Madhuri Dixit. Nana struck up friendships with Shroff and Kapoor that lasted till his final years.

He turned director with 'Prahaar: The Final Attack' (1991), in which he played an Indian Army officer and underwent rigorous training for the role. In 'Angaar' (1992), he won his first Filmfare Award for 'Best Villain'. The same year, 'Raju Ban Gaya Gentleman' showed another side of him, proving that the actor couldn't be boxed into a single genre.

THROUGH NAAM FOUNDATION, THE VETERAN ACTOR EXTENDED TO WATER CONSERVATION AND WATERSHED MANAGEMENT IN RURAL MAHARASHTRA

Then came 'Krantiveer' (1994). As a wayward, gambling young man who finds a purpose in fighting injustice, Nana delivered one of the defining performances of his career. Through the 1990s and 2000s, he moved between lead roles, character parts, smaller films and mainstream blockbusters, refusing to let success dictate what kind of actor he should be. In 'Agni Sakshi' (1996), he was so convincing as a psychotic husband that audiences despised the man he played. In Sanjay Leela Bhansali's 'Khamoshi: The Musical' (1996), the same actor became a deaf-mute father to Manisha Koirala.

Then came 'Ab Tak Chhappan', where he played a Mumbai police encounter specialist with a cold, controlled intensity. And when he turned to comedy, he revealed yet another facet of himself. 'Taxi No. 9 2 11: Nau Do Gyarah' brought his comic timing to the fore, while 'Welcome' gave popular culture one of its most enduring comic characters, Uday Shetty. Almost every line he delivered in the film became part of the popular lexicon.

And then, in 2016, came 'Natsamrat'. As Ganpat Belwalkar, a celebrated stage actor who retires at the peak of his fame, gives away everything he owns to his children and is eventually forced to confront their ingratitude, Nana delivered one of the finest performances of his career. The film remains one of Marathi cinema's most acclaimed works.

That, perhaps, was Nana's greatest strength: he could never be reduced to a type. But there was another Nana, the man outside the screen, and perhaps that was where his idea of heroism came alive.

Born into a lower-middle-class Maharashtrian family, Nana never allowed stardom to erase his roots. On an episode of 'Kaun Banega Crorepati', he put his relationship with the film industry simply: "I am not from the industry. I come here, work here and then go back. I am from the village and I will stay there."

In 2015, Nana, along with Marathi actor Makarand Anaspure, launched the Naam Foundation in Pune to support farmers affected by severe drought and indebtedness. The initiative began after Nana decided against buying a luxury car reportedly worth around Rs 1.5 crore and chose instead to use the money to help families of farmers who had died by suicide in drought-hit regions such as Vidarbha and Marathwada.

Through Naam Foundation, his work extended to water conservation and watershed management in rural Maharashtra, while support was also provided to families devastated by farmer suicides. "The work he did in the rural areas of Maharashtra in the fields of water conservation and watershed management through the 'Naam Foundation' is noteworthy and significant. The helping hand he extended to the families of farmers who committed suicide became a support for many families. Nana was not only an excellent artist-actor but also a personality sensitive towards society," wrote Union Minister Nitin Gadkari after the demise of Nana. Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis recalled the actor's involvement in the Jalyukt Shivar campaign and his work with farmers. "Whether it was aiding farmers or extending a helping hand during times of drought, Nana always led from the front," he wrote.

He later adopted multiple schools for families affected by cross-border shelling in Jammu and Kashmir's Rajouri and Poonch districts and collaborated with the Army on skill-development initiatives. Till the last moment, Nana remained a simple man who never let stardom define him.

WHEN NANA PATEKAR WENT TO KARGIL WAR FRONT



During the Kargil War in 1999, Nana Patekar put his acting career on hold and asked for permission to join the Indian Army at the war front. He later spoke about this lesser-known chapter of his life on 'Kaun Banega Crorepati'.

He had already trained with the Maratha Light Infantry for three years for his film 'Prahaar: The Final Attack', in which he played Major Vs Chavan. He also wrote and directed the film. When the Kargil conflict broke out, the actor approached senior Army officers and asked him to join the troops. He was told that he needed permission from the Defence Minister. "I knew our Defence Minister George Fernandes ji, so I called him. Even he said it was impossible," the actor said during a KBC episode in August 2024. He then reminded Fernandes about his three years of military training. Fernandes eventually gave him permission to go.

The 'Welcome' actor travelled to the Kargil conflict zone in August 1999 and spent around 60 days with Army personnel near the Line of Control. He travelled to places including Dras, Leh, Kupwara, Baramulla and Sopore.

During his time there, he also became part of a Quick Reaction Team and later helped at a military hospital in Srinagar.

Tributes Pour In

AKSHAY KUMAR

"Really saddened by the news of Nana ji's passing. He was one of those rare actors who never needed to do too much to make you sit up and watch. That voice, that intensity, that honesty in every performance... He was completely his own. I feel fortunate that we got to work together in 'Welcome'..."

PARESH RAWAL

"Bhau. Nana Saheb. Insanely honest and intense. Love and respect forever. Aum Shanti."

MANISHA KOIRALA

"Deeply saddened by the passing of a great actor, a remarkable presence and a true stalwart of the craft. His contribution to cinema and his dedication to his craft will always be remembered. May his soul rest in peace. Om Shanti."

Nana Patekar: The making of an unforgettable man

AMIT GOEL
New Delhi, October 8



There is a particular kind of actor who cannot be contained by a role. Who walks into a scene and immediately makes it his own. Whose face, however unfamiliar the character, remains recognisably itself. Nana Patekar is that kind of actor. He could play gangsters and generals, clowns and revolutionaries, a broken old theatre legend dissolving quietly into forgetting. He could do all of this and still, behind every mask, you could feel him there: the man himself, watching you back.

Understanding why requires going further back than cinema. Nana Patekar was born Vishwanath Patekar in Murud-Janjira, a coastal town in Maharashtra. His early childhood was not without comfort. His father worked in textiles and the family lived reasonably well, until they didn't. A trusted associate cheated his father and the business collapsed. Overnight, reasonable became something else entirely. Nana was still in Class IX when he began working. Each morning, he went to school and each afternoon he walked to Chunabhatti, where he painted film hoardings. The wage was Rs 35 rupees a month. The bonus was one meal. He later described hunger and humiliation as his two great teachers. He didn't study poverty from a distance. He lived inside it and the living left its marks.

Before cinema, there was theatre. And before theatre gave him an art form, it gave him something more immediate: his father's attention. Nana had begun performing in village plays while still in school. But something shifted when he did a play called 'Valmiki' and his father, who loved both theatre and films, travelled from Mumbai to see it. For the young Nana, the experience was a revelation. The stage could bring his father closer. That was reason enough to continue.

Even as films brought him recognition, he never stopped returning to theatre. His celebrated Marathi play 'Purush' ran for 16 years. Then came 'Parinda' in 1989. His portrayal of Anna, a ruthless gangster of terrible charisma, remains one of the defining performances of that decade in Indian cinema. But the film nearly consumed him, literally. The climactic fire sequence was shot with real flames, digital effects not yet being available. Nana was actually burned during filming. He was hospitalised for roughly 60 days and couldn't work for months.

HE NEVER WORKED PARTICULARLY HARD TO BE LIKED. HE SIMPLY KEPT SHOWING UP, AS HIMSELF, IN ALL HIS UNCOMFORTABLE ENTIRETY

There is a story, though, that tells you more about the actor than most of his performances combined. It involved no cameras. Veteran actor Ashok Saraf once recalled a night during a touring performance of 'Hamidabai Ki Kothi'. The show was being staged in a mill without a proper stage. The audience turned volatile. Chairs broke, lights broke and the situation lurched toward genuine danger. Nana assessed the room immediately and understood that Saraf, the elder colleague, was most at risk. He grabbed him and moved. They ran through darkness and mud until they reached the main road, at which point Nana stopped a rickshaw, placed Saraf inside, asked the driver to move aside and drove the vehicle himself to safety. Then he went back for the others. The full group eventually left together under police protection at around 3 am. In the moment that called for clarity and courage, this was the man who produced both: the same man with the famous temper, the confrontational reputation, the impatience with pretence. Under pressure, he became someone who thought of others first and returned to danger to make sure they got out.

Nana has spoken openly about his temper, about people he may have hurt, about the times when his sharpness drew blood it didn't need to draw. But he has also said something that catches you off-guard in its severity: if he has made a mistake, people shouldn't forget it or excuse it. They should punish him. He doesn't seem to want your forgiveness so much as your honesty. And perhaps that's why audiences have trusted him for so long. He never worked particularly hard to be liked. He simply kept showing up, as himself, in all his uncomfortable entirety.

There is a role, though, that seems almost fated, looking back. Appa Belwalkar in 'Natsamrat' is an ageing theatre legend who has given everything to the stage. For Nana, who came to cinema only because theatre couldn't hold everything he needed, who spent decades refusing to let the screen replace the stage, the performance carried an unusual emotional charge. It wasn't simply an actor playing an old actor. It was something more intimate: a man in conversation with the choices that had made him.